

CCL 25

Summary

CCL 25	1
General information	6
Suggested books.....	6
Exam.....	6
First lesson	7
Dry Path Knowledge (Convergent Thinking)	7
Wet Path Knowledge (Divergent Thinking)	7
Pensare.....	7
Approach of Formalization of Questions	7
"Dura lex, sed lex"	8
Ius Positum (Positive Law)	9
Word -> Action	9
Degrowth.....	9
Heidegger and the Deconstruction of Philosophy	9
"In der Welt sein" (Being-in-the-World)	10
"In der Web sein" or "Im Netz sein" (Being in the Web).....	10
Hermeneutics.....	10
Phenomenology.....	12
Example	12
Second Lesson.....	14
What Is Being?	14
The Apple and the Question of Truth.....	15
Identity: Identifiable vs. Identitarian	15
The Law and Human Change	15
Dasein: The Human as a Being-There.....	16
Human vs. Artificial Intelligence	16
The Time of Thought	17
Project vs. Program	17
Third lesson.....	19
Possibilities.....	19
Memory	20
Experiments and experiences.....	20

Facts.....	20
Earthly-order.....	21
Digital umwelt.....	22
Disorientation	22
Uprooting	22
Homesickness	22
Hyperinflation	23
Being free by/from and being free with	24
Nihilism	24
Being and time	25
Being in the net.....	25
Da-sein	26
Fourth lesson	27
Caring.....	27
Rück-sicht and nach-sicht	27
Tools.....	28
Likes	29
"I" and "alter"	30
Manipulation of images	32
Fifth Lesson	34
Heidegger and the Dictatorship of Mediocrity.....	34
Dasein, Being-in-the-World, and Co-Existence	34
The Ambiguity of Care and the Problem of Substitution	34
Publicity, Visibility, and the Paradox of Exposure	34
Alteration and the Phenomenology of Comparison.....	35
The Role of Platforms and the Quantification of Meaning	35
Das Man in the Digital Age	35
Power Beyond Law: Ontological Implications for Cyber Law.....	35
Authenticity and the Ethical Stakes of Technological Mediation	35
The Dual Nature of Power: Capability and Domination	36
Macht and Herrschaft: Two Logics of Power	36
The Fragility of Coercion: Violence as Weakness.....	36
Persuasive Power in the Digital Age.....	36
Three Semantic Forms of Power	36
The Power of the Sword (Schwertmacht):.....	36
The Power of the Law (Gesetzesmacht):.....	37
The Power of Habit (Gewohnheitsmacht):.....	37

From Apparatus to Ontology: Platform Power	37
Time, Labor, and Contemplation.....	37
The Silent Drift Toward Domination	37
Sixth lesson.....	38
Truth and transparency.....	38
What is the truth?	38
Secondary type truth	39
Example of truth in 16th century	39
Truth in a secondary sense	39
Recognize the truth	39
Interpretation of facts	40
Truth as inter subjective relationship.....	40
Truth and lie.....	41
The nature of the truth	42
Contemplation.....	42
Transparency and appearance	42
Nachsicht and rücksicht.....	43
Lichtung.....	43
Digital panopticon	44
Stories.....	44
Noise	45
Trust	45
Panopticon.....	45
Some reflections.....	46
Seventh lesson	48
Truth in Three Societies.....	48
Information vs. Narration	48
Truth and Transparency	48
Identity and Apparition	49
Commodification of Vulnerability	49
Fragmented Realities and Digital Solitude.....	49
Performing Connection	50
The Emotional Economy of the Network	50
Transparency as Control	50
Architecture of Power.....	51
Digital Tools and Mimicry	51
Capitalism as Cult	52

Neo-Management and Human Cost	52
The Ideological Framework of Capitalism	53
The Emotional Exploitation of Workers	53
Sacrifice Without Community	53
The Narcissistic Pact	54
Quiet Quitting and the Rise of Passive Resistance	54
Capitalism as Anti-Religion.....	54
Eighth Lesson.....	55
Two Christian Roots of Capitalism	55
The Protestant Ethic and the Spirit of Capitalism	55
Market, Soul, and the Religious Logic of Capital	55
The Rise and Retreat of the Welfare State	56
Meritocracy and the Ethical Justification of Inequality	56
From the Worker to the Consumer: A Shift in Capitalist Theology	56
The Disintegration of Community	57
Idolatry, Sacrifice, and the New Religious Order	57
The Taboo of the Gift	57
Storytelling, Branding, and the Commodification of Meaning	58
Ninth lesson	59
Capitalism	59
Care	59
To be in a role.....	60
Gift.....	60
Gift in the domestic world	61
Gender disparity	61
Market of care	62
Care market laws.....	62
Feast	62
Capitalism and feast	63
Feast and religion	63
Fallow and the law of the seventh day	64
Symbolic capitals.....	64
Utopia	65
Divertimento	65
Tenth lesson	66
The Fusion of Systems and the Digital Condition.....	66
Exposure, Performance, and the Collapse of Intimacy	66

Emotional Distancing and the Commodification of Fragility	66
Algorithmic Identity and Stereotype Reinforcement.....	67
The TikTok Aesthetic and the Artificial Authenticity	67
The Brain Rot Phenomenon and Content Degradation.....	67
Sharenting	67
Misery Shows and the Spectacularization of Suffering.....	68
Vibes, Authenticity, and the Production of Atmosphere.....	68
Geopolitics of Platforms: Western vs. Chinese TikTok	68
Government Propaganda and Militarization of Cool.....	68
From Visibility to Identity: The Platform Self.....	68
The Ethical Challenge of the Digital Age	69
Possible questions for the oral exam.....	70

First lesson

Dry Path Knowledge (Convergent Thinking)

Dry path knowledge refers to disciplines like **computer science and mathematics**, where learning follows a structured, logical, and often deterministic approach. In these fields, problems usually have **clear, definitive solutions**, and reasoning is **convergent**, meaning it narrows down multiple possibilities to a single, correct answer. This type of knowledge is foundational in areas such as **cryptography, algorithms, and cybersecurity protocols**, where precision and accuracy are essential.

Wet Path Knowledge (Divergent Thinking)

In contrast, wet path knowledge is associated with disciplines like **philosophy, ethics, and social sciences**, where learning is more fluid, creative, and unpredictable. Here, reasoning is **divergent**, meaning it explores multiple perspectives and solutions rather than converging on a single answer. This approach is particularly relevant in **cyber law and digital ethics**, where legal and moral dilemmas—such as privacy rights, AI regulation, and digital free speech—require nuanced, adaptable thinking rather than rigid formulas.

Between these two sides there is a meeting point, where both the parts can capture something by the other.

Pensare

The key is to “**think**”, in italian “**pensare**”, that comes from the Latin “**pensum**”, which originally meant “**to weigh**” or “**to evaluate carefully**”. This makes sense because thinking is essentially about considering different possibilities and making judgments.

A useful way to look at thinking is as a process of **turning something messy into something structured**. When we think, we start with **raw, unorganized ideas**, things that don't yet have a clear shape or direction. Through reasoning, analysis and problem-solving, we gradually **sort through the chaos and create a structured, linear understanding** of the situation.

Approach of Formalization of Questions

Formalizing a question means **structuring it in a precise and unambiguous way** to avoid misunderstandings, especially in fields like **computer science, law and logic**.

A great example of this is the classic joke about a **programmer's mom**:

Mom: "Go to the grocery store and buy milk. If they have eggs, buy six."

Programmer: Buys six liters of milk.

This happens because a programmer interprets instructions **literally**. The phrase "If they have eggs, buy six" is ambiguous. A human might infer that it refers to eggs, but a strict, logical reading could apply "six" to the last noun mentioned, milk.

To avoid confusion, the instruction could be rewritten in a more structured way:

"Go to the grocery store. Buy one bottle of milk. If they have eggs, also buy six eggs."

This way, even a **literal-minded person (or computer program)** would understand the intended meaning correctly.

Formalization applies to **philosophy** as well, especially in **analytic philosophy and hermeneutics**, where precision in language is crucial.

Let's analyze the phrase:

"Sein das verstanden werden kann ist Sprache."

(Being, which can be understood, is language.)

This sentence, attributed to **Gadamer**, suggests that **"Being" (Sein) is fundamentally linked to language**, as only what can be understood can be expressed in language. The **commas** indicate a **relative clause ("das verstanden werden kann")**, which clarifies **Sein**, it refers specifically to the kind of "Being" that can be understood.

Now, without the comma:

"Sein das verstanden werden kann, ist Sprache."

(Being which can be understood, is language.)

Without commas, the sentence becomes more ambiguous. In German, **relative clauses are usually set off by commas**, so removing them makes it less clear **what exactly is being defined**. It could now be read as a continuous statement, which might suggest that **understood being itself is identical to language**, rather than just being describable through it.

"Dura lex, sed lex"

This Latin phrase means **"The law is harsh, but it is the law."** It reflects the idea that, regardless of how difficult or unfair a law may seem, it must be followed. It emphasizes the **binding nature of law** over individual moral judgment.

Ius Positum (Positive Law)

"Ius positum" refers to **law that is established or enacted by human authorities**, rather than law based on principles. It's the idea of **law as it is written and enforced**, regardless of its fairness or moral correctness.

Word -> Action

- **Word:** This represents **communication**, an idea, instruction, or concept expressed through language. Words are the initial step in conveying meaning, whether in speech, writing, or thought.
- **Conversion:** This is the **transformation** of words into something more practical or applicable. It involves interpreting or processing the meaning of the words, often turning abstract concepts or instructions into something **clearer or actionable**.
- **Action:** This is the **final result**, where the meaning or idea behind the words is put into practice. Action is the execution of what was intended or communicated, whether it's a physical task or a mental process.

Degrowth

Degrowth is an economic and social movement that advocates for the **reduction of unnecessary production and consumption** to promote **sustainability, well-being, and environmental preservation**.

In a **degrowth** framework, the goal is to **reduce excess production**, goods and services that are unnecessary, wasteful, or harmful to the environment. This includes products that contribute to overconsumption, environmental degradation, and the depletion of natural resources.

Instead of striving for endless **economic expansion**, the focus shifts to creating a society where people **consume responsibly** and **value quality over quantity**. The aim is not to reduce overall well-being but to **improve it by focusing on meaningful, sustainable activities** that contribute to human happiness and ecological health.

Heidegger and the Deconstruction of Philosophy

Martin Heidegger, a prominent 20th-century philosopher, is known for his **deconstruction of traditional philosophy** and his **radical rethinking** of the fundamental questions of existence. Heidegger's work, particularly in his magnum opus "**Being and Time**", challenged conventional metaphysical frameworks and attempted to return philosophy to its **origins**, asking the most fundamental questions of human existence, such as "**What is human being?**" and "**Why do we die?**"

Heidegger critiqued the history of Western philosophy (metafísica), which he believed had become overly focused on concepts and detached from **the lived experience of being**. He argued that philosophers had neglected the most basic question of all: **What does it mean to be?** Heidegger referred to this as the question of **Being** (or "Sein"), which he thought had been overshadowed by **ontological and epistemological concerns** (i.e., the study of what exists and how we know it). His deconstruction sought to **reclaim** the question of Being as the central issue of philosophy.

"In der Welt sein" (Being-in-the-World)

"In der Welt sein" literally means "to be in the world", and it refers to the human condition of being fundamentally embedded in the world. For Heidegger, **being-in-the-world** is not just about physical existence in the world, but also about **our relationship to it**, how we engage with, interpret, and relate to the world around us.

Heidegger argues that humans are always already **in the world** and that **our experience of existence is always contextual and interconnected**. We do not exist in isolation but are part of a larger web of relationships, objects, language, and meanings that shape our understanding of who we are. This concept challenges the traditional philosophical view of humans as detached, thinking subjects separate from the world.

"In der Web sein" (Being in the Web)

In contrast, "**in der Web sein**" refers to being present or engaged in the **digital world**, particularly the **internet**. While Heidegger never dealt directly with the concept of the internet, we can apply his idea of "being-in-the-world" to the **contemporary condition** of being connected through the web.

"**In the Web**" refers to how modern humans interact with digital spaces—whether through social media, websites, or digital communication. This idea can be seen as a **new form of being-in-the-world**, where our relationships, identities, and actions are increasingly shaped by digital technologies. Like Heidegger's original idea, **being in the web** is not just about existing online, but also about how our experience, interactions, and understanding of ourselves and the world are altered by **digital engagement**.

We are saved by the net (think about the pandemic period), but here we can't build ideas or a stable community.

Hermeneutics

It's the science of interpretation, a skill that machines do not have: machines can only calculate and pair but do not have the capacity to evaluate in a deeper way. In order to interpret something, we need to have:

- a text
- a context

If we only say "*family*" and we get asked to define it, we will need to know something about where is the family, and when, what type, ...

Also, in italian: "*Se avete problemi, basta parlare*", "*basta parlare*" can have two meanings depending on the context.

Hermeneutics is the process of interpreting words by considering both the **text** and the **context** to give them meaning. Since **law** is made up of words, understanding hermeneutics is important for interpreting legal texts, including **cyber and computer law**.

The term comes from **Hermes**, the Greek god who was the messenger between the gods and humans. He also protected **merchants** (who exchange goods) and **thieves** (robbers).

What do merchants and thieves have in common? When we interpret text or words, there's always something that we **take** or **exchange**. We might not fully understand every single word, but by considering the **text** and **context**, we can give more meaning to simple words or concepts.

There's a kind of **transaction** happening. For example, some languages don't have certain words, so we use **paraphrases** to make the concept clearer.

As for the **thieves** part: when we understand something, we're **grabbing** meaning from it, much like how we understand poetry or music. Even if we don't understand every single word or note, we still get the **overall sense**. The interpreter does something similar—taking and **appropriating** the meaning.

"**Logos**" comes from the Greek word **λόγος**.

The word "**intelligence**" comes from the Latin "**intelligere**", which is derived from "**inter-**" (meaning "between") and "**legere**" (meaning "to read" or "to choose"). So, intelligence can be understood as the ability to "read between" things or to understand more deeply, to grasp the connections or relationships that are not immediately obvious.

It suggests an ability to perceive not just the surface meaning of things but to interpret and understand them on a deeper level, recognizing patterns, nuances, and underlying truths. This kind of understanding requires more than just surface knowledge, it's about the ability to make connections, to see the bigger picture, and to understand the "in-between" spaces where deeper meaning lies.

According to Aristotele, humans are distinct from other animals because they are **rational beings** who possess **language**. In his work *Politics*, Aristotle argues that humans are the

only creatures capable of **speech (logos)**, which allows them to **communicate reason** and to express thoughts, feelings, and concepts in a sophisticated way.

On the other hand, **animals** communicate primarily through **instinct and sounds** (like calls or cries). Their communication is limited to expressing basic needs or emotions, such as hunger or fear. In contrast, human language enables us to discuss abstract ideas, make judgments, and engage in complex reasoning, which sets us apart from other species.

In this sense, **language** is one of the key factors that makes humans **unique**, as it's tied to our capacity for **reasoning** and **judgment**.

Justice is characterized by ambiguity and uncertainty and follows the **nomological coalescence**: norms are written in words and words have to follow some syntactical norms.

Phenomenology

Phenomenology is the study of phenomena, a term that comes from the Greek word **φαίνομαι** [fainomai], meaning **to appear** or **to show oneself**. Although it might seem challenging at first, this field of study is crucial for developing **divergent thinking**—the ability to approach problems from multiple perspectives. Unlike **convergent thinking**, which seeks a single correct solution, **divergent thinking** embraces multiple possibilities and is essential for **critical thinking**.

The concept of **φαίνομαι** involves not presenting facts, because facts themselves might not be as absolute as we think (but that's a topic for another time). Instead, we focus on how events **appear** or how they **present themselves** to us. For example, both the **web** and **law** are phenomena that can be observed in the way they present themselves, not necessarily as absolute truths.

There's a distinction between what **appears** and what **actually is**, and as we explore this further, we will gradually peel back layers of these phenomena to try and get to their essence. To do this, we will use the tools of **divergent thinking** and **critical analysis**.

Example

Let's take **cyber and computer law** as an example. Where do these words come from?

- **Cyber** comes from the Greek word **κυβερνήτης** [kubernetes], which is derived from **κυβερνάω** [kubernao], meaning **"to drive"** or **"to lead"**. The idea here is that this leading should be **autonomous**. Originally, cybernetics was about the interaction between a living being (like a human) and something non-living. The concept has evolved to mean making this control or "piloting" **autonomous**. But is

this dangerous? If an autonomous system causes an accident, who is responsible? This is a long-standing question, and it's still relevant today.

- **Computer** comes from the word **computation**, which comes from "**count**", and before that, "**computare**" (from **cum** meaning together and **putare** meaning to evaluate). The idea is that when we evaluate, we are measuring something, and in doing so, we **select** what to include and what to leave out. The word **putare** also means to clean or cut, which is why in Italian "**potare**" means "**to cut**". In a sense, **computers** are all about calculation. But we need to remember that humans have two main types of thinking:
 1. **Mathematical thinking**
 2. **Meditative thinking** While computers can handle one of these (mathematical thinking), they don't have meditative thinking like humans do.
- **Law** (or **legge**) comes from the Latin "**lego**", which means to **connect**. For example, "**intelligence**" comes from "**intellego**" (which has "**lego**" in it), meaning to **connect things that seem unrelated** and solve problems by making those connections. Law, in this sense, is about connecting different elements to form rules and systems. Of course, law has other meanings too, but that's a basic idea for now.

Second Lesson

Let us begin with a word: **Seinsvergessenheit**.

A strange, compound term introduced by Heidegger—dense, yet revealing. To truly understand it, we must break it down:

- **Sein** — *Being*
- **Vergessen** — *To forget*
- **-heit** — A suffix indicating a state or condition, akin to *-ness* or the Italian *-ità*

Thus, *Seinsvergessenheit* translates to **the forgetfulness of Being**. Heidegger identifies this as the defining illness of our age: not merely a forgetting of something, but of **Being itself**—of what it means to be.

What Is Being?

To define *Being* is already to encounter a paradox. We are forced to use the verb "is" to define the very ground of "is-ness."

Being can gesture toward:

- Existence
- Essence
- Intention
- Mood or internal state
- Purpose or orientation

We associate *Being* with what is stable, nameable, observable—something that can be fixed in language or measured by thought. In this way, *Being* becomes a word for **reality**, a reality stabilized and crystallized through **concepts**.

And yet, perception is not infinite. Our senses offer only a narrow slice of the world—our hearing is limited to 20-20,000 Hz, our vision to a sliver of the electromagnetic spectrum. Still, from this finitude, we construct meaning.

We attempt to shape the flux of the world into *logos* (λόγος)—a Greek term not limited to "word," but extending to **narration, explanation, reason, theory**. Through *logos*, we build the frameworks of law, science and society. But words, unlike numbers, are ambiguous.

They carry sedimented layers of meaning and cultural inheritance. Their meanings are not fixed but fluid, shifting with context and history.

Philosophy, then, becomes the art of un-forgetting—the discipline that interrogates what has been taken for granted. Where animals respond to stimuli, we pose questions. This capacity for questioning defines our **intelligence**.

The Apple and the Question of Truth

Consider this example:

A man walks out of a market. From his bag falls an apple. I pass by and see it. "There is an apple," I say. Another passerby confirms it. The next day, the apple remains, but it begins to rot. Days later, it's decomposing—only a moist patch of earth remains. Then, in the same spot, I see a sprout. Later, a sapling. Eventually, a tree.

Now the question: **Was it ever an apple? Is it still true to say so?**

Truth, it seems, is not static. It is temporal—revealed in stages. A thing *was* an apple, and that truth coexists with what it *is* now. Memory and becoming blur the edges of identity.

A similar thought arises from personal photographs.

A picture of you at 2, another at 12, and now you're 20. Are you still that 2-year-old? That 12-year-old? In what sense is your identity continuous?

Identity: Identifiable vs. Identitarian

Identity splits into two meanings, often confused:

- **Identifiable:** The social need to be catalogued—name, surname, ID number, profession. It's how society stabilizes who you are for bureaucratic, legal, and interpersonal coherence.
- **Identitarian:** The philosophical question: *What makes you, you?* This identity is built not on sameness, but on **difference**, **originality**, and **interiority**—on that which makes you singular.

The Law and Human Change

Law provides stability. It allows us to predict behavior, establish norms, and coexist. But laws, like the humans they serve, are not immutable. They must evolve alongside culture, technology, and thought.

Justice, therefore, must flow with the current of **becoming**, not freeze it.

Dasein: The Human as a Being-There

Heidegger departs from classical philosophy by refusing to define *Being* from the outside. He does not start from reality as something objective, measurable. Instead, he begins from within—from human experience itself.

He calls this unique human mode of Being: **Dasein**.

- **Da** — *Here*
- **Sein** — *Being*

Dasein is not just a biological organism—it is a being *aware* of its being. This self-awareness sets us apart. It births language, memory, judgment, and longing. It carries us beyond mere presence and into **existence**.

Two existential structures define Dasein:

1. **Geworfenheit** — *Thrownness*:

We are cast into existence without consent—no choice in when, where, or to whom we are born. Yet we do not accept this passively.

2. **Entwurf** — *Project*:

We respond to our thrownness by creating projects—*Pro-ject*: to throw forward. We cast ourselves into possibilities, always shaping the world and ourselves through what we imagine and strive toward.

From this condition arises a third insight:

- **Sein-zum-Tode** — *Being-toward-death*:

Death is not merely an end; it is the horizon against which life gains its urgency and shape. Dasein lives in anticipation, as a **bundle of possibilities**, some realized, most not. Our intelligence emerges from this fertile tension.

Human vs. Artificial Intelligence

To understand ourselves in the age of machines, we must ask: **What distinguishes human intelligence from artificial intelligence?**

First, human intelligence is rooted in **movement**. In Greek, *dunamis* (δύναμις)—**power, potential, becoming**—names both strength and motion. Intelligence for humans is

dynamic, elastic. It adapts, transforms, evolves through experience and —crucially— through **error**.

An error is only identifiable **after** the fact, in light of a “correct” path. But how can one find the right way without having wandered? Only by veering off course do we learn where the course lies.

This is why human intelligence thrives on two essential movements:

- **To Wander**
- **To Wonder**

Both words share a common root. One refers to moving through the unknown; the other to being astonished, curious, fearful. From this kinship arises the Greek **thauma** (θαῦμα)—the root of all philosophy. That which *makes us ask*.

Wonder does not arise from novelty alone. Even the new can become dull through repetition. What awakens wonder is the **unexpected**, the **unforeseen**—the anomaly that resists categorization.

The Time of Thought

To wander and wonder requires **time**. To err, to doubt, to revise, to reflect—these are not quick tasks. They cannot be optimized. They cannot be programmed.

In a trial, the judge does not decide instantly. They *ponder*. The Latin root of “pensare” (to think) is *pondus*—**to weigh**. Thinking, like justice, needs stillness, delay, and internal space.

This slowness is often seen as a defect in a world that worships efficiency. But it is essential to what makes us human. Our most profound capacities—doubt, memory, second thoughts, judgment—are **dysfunctional** by design. They resist automation.

Project vs. Program

Let’s return to Heidegger’s distinction:

- **Entwurf / Project** — Human. Open-ended. Trial-and-error. Born of thrownness and yearning.
- **Program / Pre-written law** — Animal, plant, machine. Functioning by pre-determined logic. No deviation allowed.

Humans must *decide* what laws to follow. We must *construct* justice. This is not a bug—it is the defining feature of existence.

We are not here simply to function. We are here to **be**.

Third lesson

We started from the idea that our intelligence is **dynamic**: it's characterized by capability and movement. It moves free to complete our projects using the resources and the possibilities that our world offers.

Sometimes we can be in situation of challenging or errors (**MIS-TAKE**): it means that we can take something wrongly. It is the opposite of intelligence, that comes from INTER-LEGERE or INTUS-LEGERE, where "legere" means to connect. while "inter" means between. So, the intelligence is the ability to read deeply ("intus") what is behind. These are our abilities, that differentiate us to the other animals or objects.

We saw also ERRARE, that is to be wrong, but also to WANDER, in fact if a human wanders without a fixed purpose, he can lead to unexpected wonders along the way.

DA-SEIN: it was used by Heidegger and it means to be here, to be aware, to be present, to be alive. It's the complexity of the possibilities to achieve something and also the result of the project that we can realize.

Possibilities

Possibilities have two characteristics:

- 1) **Uncertainty**. Possibilities are inherently tied to **uncertainty**: they suggest that something might happen, but there is no guarantee. They introduce **risk** and **ambiguity**, as not all possibilities will materialize or lead to favorable outcomes. It is this uncertainty that often drives curiosity and the desire to explore or test what is possible.
- 2) The possibility to **nullify the others**. Some possibilities are **mutually exclusive**, meaning the realization of one negates the others. For example, choosing to take one specific path at a fork in the road nullifies the possibility of taking the other path. This is often referred to as a **decision paradox**, where each choice comes with the cost of the alternatives.

The project of each human has to be enlightened from the very end: if we see our project by the point of view that it can be nullified by the others, we have to choose accurately what we have to do. So, we have to be **authentic**.

UNEIGENTLICHKEIT: Heidegger used it to indicate the **inauthenticity** and it refers to a mode of existence where an individual is not fully true to themselves or their potential. It refers to our properties, not just material, but what it's most appropriate for us. To achieve the result we have to pass through experiences, errors, mistakes...

In the humans life there are several things that are not useful for the human purpose: they are called **dysfunctional**. They have to be free, as **memory, reflection...**

Memory

Our devices have a lot of memory, but not the capability to **RE-CORDARE**, where “RE” means “again” and “COR” is the hearth. So it refers to something that stays in the core and it’s important to remember for us.

Humans can re-elaborate, go back and for this we have a **language**. Devices can’t operate on the basis of laws that characterize this language.

Heidegger says that “*Science doesn’t think*”. This is not a judgement, but it’s an observation that want to highlights the perimeter of interests of science: its goal is not to think, but to operate. The absence of human activities as recordare, doubting, questioning tells us that the scientific knowledge is poorer than other ones, that are characterized by all these dysfunctional activities.

Experiments and experiences

Experiences are different from experiments.

Experiments must be repeatable, so they have to be characterized by a **rational** and **objective** point of view. Each scientific methodology depends on formulas and constructions used by the specific science. Each one has a specific language and we accept the idea that in the history, the science follows different paths.

Example:

We can ask to four different people the **experience** of observing the moon. We can see different interpretation depending on what we ask and to which person.

If we have an astronomer, an astrologer, an astronaut and a poet, they give different answers basing on their experiences. In this way, we can see their point.

Is there a scale of priority of point of views?

Phenomenology allows to claim the possibility to observe phenomena that are not scientific and are valid among peers. In fact, for example, the point of view of an astronaut is specific. So we can have different angles, different interpretation and different aspects evaluation: they are not just facts, but also involve an interpretation of them.

Facts

“It’s raining”: it’s a fact and it’s not reducible to a subjective perception.

Can the facts speak for themselves? Can the rain say “I’m raining”?

Facts need people to narrate them. Is it possible to not enter in the fact?

Even the scientists will try to get rid of the **bias**, that is trying to disappear as an individual (a single, concrete, individual person with his personal issues) behind the question of the science, that is not to influence his own experiment with his own personal experience.

For this reason we might say that the scientific knowledge is neutral.

But aren’t the questions that we ask already full of theory? Do these questions already have an address, a direction, a particular purpose which is disconnected to a specific point of observation?

Our questions, mistakes, experiences flow into the heritage of our knowledge that is the set of tools that we use when pursuing an existential purpose, not regarding it to the small frame of a single program, but regard it in the whole complexity of the project.

We have seen that difference is important in **democracy**: laws must underline the equality and the differences. We have to protect it, understanding what differentiates my opinion. otherwise we have a formal democracy.

The right path for men for is not the goal itself or at least is not the idea of reaching it immediately, the project is made up of a component of exploration and a lot of wonder, and experiencing different **point of views**.

Our intelligence is dynamic in the sense that it’s capable of gathering together elements that are not immediately connectable to each other and of making them something new, broader, and especially something unpredictable, surprising.

We are used to perceive reality in terms of **stimulations** and **surprises** that, when connected to our senses, generate **experiences**. The information that is the narrative of facts simulates events and tries to capture and emulate the thrill of surprise.

What is the reason that makes it possible? It’s to live every day of our life.

Earthly-order

At a certain point in his history, men relied on the **earthly order**, which is made up of things, objects, tools which make the natural environment that we encounter (**WELT**).

We make this natural order/environment an environment that is technically predisposed to be inhabited by humans (**UM-WELT**), in the earthly orders entities have the task of stabilizing the human life, its activities, offering men a basis for creating an order starting from the chaos of the world or what we perceive as a chaos, differently from other leaving beings. Our world is unknown.

HABITARE: it means "living" (becoming familiar) and has to do with the habits and with habitus, that is a dress proper to our body.

Digital umwelt

Our habits structure our existences, by living we create some habitus that becomes our life, but in **digital umwelt** we have no difficulties to habit something: the web is good to connect, but not to live on. It's intelligent because it's based on the fact that we can move free, but we can't habit it.

It's characterized by:

- **DISORIENTATION (RATLOSIGKEIT);**
- **UPROOTING (BODENLOSIGKEIT);**
- **HOMESICKNESS (HEIMATLOSIGKEIT).**

Disorientation

The online life (or **online**) gives a sense of **disorientation**: there are new perceptions and even if we are in one place, in reality we are in different places at the same time. But we are alone and the disorientation is caused by the absence of the others.

Uprooting

Uprooting refers to the experience of being removed or leaving a familiar place, lifestyle or social network, often involuntarily. It describes the metaphorical "pulling up of roots" that anchor someone to their home or community.

In digital life this happens because we can't perceive the space around us.

Homesickness

The time of technology, according to Heidegger tears as a way from usual way of inhabiting the world. The man condition in the age of technology is characterized by this establishment of "complete cognitive and operational dominion over reality". But also, by a specific disorientation and **detachment**.

This is why we have reached the point where we have the broadest knowledge ever achieved over objects, over things, over natural entities we know how to use and their properties, their chemical composition, but we are not able to explain what is more bad and more general.

We have a problem: what is "is"? If we, on the first place, need to find what is "**being**" because this is the problem... this is a notion over where we build up together all the others and still is the most obscure.

In general, the more we know, the less we understand. This condition is the promise of algorithmic knowledge: humans want to know how can do with their life and because another human beings do question to us.

INTER-ESSE (to be between): we are interested in asking new questions.

Hyperinflation

The world is made of **material things** and progressively **earthly-order** is substituted by **digital-order**: we translate all in digital form and we come from **real world** to **digital** one.

In this way the objects lose their value. We are not anymore interested in own thins, but we want to **access** them. And it's the goal of online **platforms**, that can involve cars, houses, books...

RE-ALITY (it comes from **RES**, that means things, objects): what orders the world is not things, but information.

We must avoid being fooled by the **hyperinflation** of the objects that surround us.

Let's make a little transition and explain history parts in a condensed way: before the industrial revolution flooded the market with goods in elevated quantity.

"**copia**" is a Latin word with two meanings:

1. "make a copy": two equal things
2. "huge quantity": the keyword of the industrial production that makes all the manufacts look the same and in huge quantities

The unity before this industrial revolution and before the unity between techno information and commercial system was fully settled, objects used to stabilize the human life by providing continuity so that men, despite the fact that they had different PoV, ever

changing nature, they can find some still points in their existence, things were anchored to reality.

The experience is attached to the real world and nowadays television formats develop emotional **detachment** of objects: things disappear and their memory loses value. So, things are translated into a value.

Connections with things or people are discouraged: we risk to have less experiences. We are **free** not only in the meaning, but also in a consumistic declination: the more we have, the better we live.

Being free by/from and being free with

Bruno Romano (professor) distinguishes freedom in two declinations:

- **being free by/from:** describes a freedom where the other is no longer with me, he's expelled from our existential horizon, we want to be free by. The ego sees in the "you" not as someone but as a something that prevents from experiencing freedom in absolute way: when we deny the idea of "you" as a person and we regard it as a "something" we have to get rid of, we can see the other as objectified. So, the other is my limit and it's the starting point of our freedom.
- **being free with:** achieves its own liberation by including the other human being in its own existential horizon and it is a freedom that implies respect and recognition as the other as our Equal. If we want somebody to be the same, it means that we are in a dictatorship.

OBJECT comes from **IACERE**, which means "to be in the middle", something that hinders our path and presents us from moving freely, something that stands in our way, occupying space.

Nihilism

The **nihilism** is a philosophical current of the past century. It affirms that everything is **senseless**. It has the goal to translate what science can't explain. It was popular in France, Germany (also Heidegger, but in different form).

Without pain and pity we get rid of things that we care about in return of a financial compensation. This progressive dissolution of things and people loses 3 dimensionality to adapt to the rigid flatness of the platforms can be described as a manifestation as a specific form of nihilism that we call **digital nihilism**.

Nihilism: comes from "**nihil**", which means "**no-thing**", while "**ni-ente**" means "no-being"

Digital: comes from "**digit**", which means "**number**" in English but the origin is "**finger**" (because we count, and also because of measurements: inches, feet, ..., everything referred from an anthropomorphic PoV).

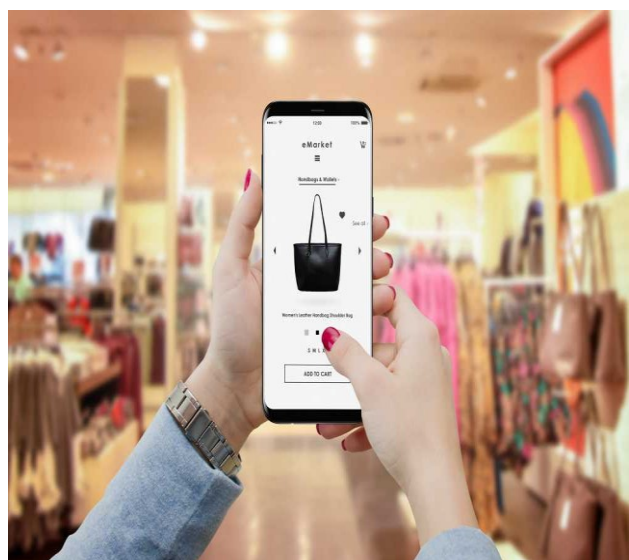
Being and time

Being and time (sein und zeit, 1927): it refers to understanding being with other point of views.

Think about the bread: before humans had to prepare it with hands, but nowadays we can order it online. So, building or preparing something is replaced by **services**. We can do everything with our devices through our fingers.

Heidegger tells us that we see something homogeneous and then we transform it into an object, because we need **ZU-HANDEN-HEIT (Readiness-to-hand**, refers to the way we encounter and use tools or objects in our everyday practical activities) and **VOR-HANDEN-HEIT (Presence-at-hand**, describes a theoretical or detached mode of encountering objects. In this mode, entities are observed, analyzed, or conceptualized as "things" with properties, independent of their practical use).

But now we don't have this exchange, but resources are given by technologies (**ZU-DIGIT-HEIT / VOR-DIGIT-HEIT**). If we don't move we don't develop our brain and we become detached.



Theodore John Kaczynski, also known as the **Unabomber**, was an American domestic terrorist, mathematician, and former university professor. He developed a radical ideology against technological advancement, arguing that it dehumanizes individuals and destroys the natural environment. His manifesto, titled "**Industrial Society and Its Future**," outlines his views. Kaczynski conducted a nationwide bombing campaign, targeting individuals associated with universities, airlines, and technology. His homemade bombs killed three people and injured 23 others.

Being in the net

Services are enforced by technologies.

Artificial Intelligence is shaping our way to relate with others. We give to calculators the responsibility of our behaviour. We don't develop strategies to survive and the dependency from these means is growing.

What if we have to pay to have them? Next generation will find these tools and develop a strategy to use them. Things appear without seeing the **process**. But if you lose the process, you are dependent on the service.

Da-sein

Heidegger develops the existential analysis (**daseinanalyse**):

- da: here
- sein: to be
- analyse: analyse

Heidegger, differently from us, he couldn't care less about differences, he said dasein, because the difference between us and other living beings is not we are not simple presence, we know that we are here, dasein means the analysis of those creatures that know that are here. In Italian we say "esserci". We are here and we know that we are here.

Heidegger describes being in the world as becoming familiar with it, through a manipulative exchange: relationship, companionship, exchange.

To be online allows only connection, but not contact. And we can do it with our fingers and through information, profiles, comments, so we live in a state of **alteration**.

INFOSPHERE (schermare, difendere) protects and screens us from the world and the others.

ALTER (ALTRO, alterate us): from a chemical point of view it means to be in contact with something that modifies the state. So, humans that are in contact can be altered.

To live online we can use some tools as silencing the other. But it doesn't work: the more you repress, more cyberbullying appears.

Online, our opinion makes our identity, because we are only what is written: if somebody is offended by our opinion, he's offended by our identity. We have only the **text** and not the **context**.

In the pandemic era, we saw the contact in two ways:

- **connection**, in fact it was the only way to remain in contact with other people;
- **contagious**, because the physical contact was a mean of contagion for Covid.

It's not possible to make all with AI: for example, the poetry, because we can't follow a regular path and we can't predict the future.

We have also two main problems: the devices don't lose the patience and the AI doesn't contrastate you.

Fourth lesson

Caring

The way Heidegger describes the constant work and constant being that characterizes the man (within a project) is called **care** (comes from "cura"), which in German is **Sorge** [sórghē], it is a Latin word that indicates at the same time

- the **attitude of attention**, commitment to something/someone
- worry, **concern**

It has these two meanings because our freedom in the search for meaning of our existence is also exposed to the meaninglessness and failure. Animals do not fail because they do not make plans, they just follow the instinctual programs.

Taking care and having care for something means working, the latter contains the idea of "effort" and the commitment to this realization, to the act of producing and to bring in out the technique that we have seen: Labor.

Labor indicates the pain of the childbirth and the fatigue of production: when we say that somebody is "in labor" it means that maybe he is having a baby (suffering for it) and also the fatigue of bringing out of something a project.

The **infosphere**, differently, is presented to us as a possibility of emancipation from the labor (inherent in care and production), freeing us from the worrying and the concern, this way the human being gradually transfers their mental skills to things, so they work for him.

This way, the subjective spirit is corrupted and transformed into the spirit of the object, but since the instrument we say "is lazy" because lacks of autonomy, it is necessary to install the instrument itself the autonomy that reflects, so that we, as human beings, can be completely freed from worries.

Rück-sicht and nach-sicht

We have two different ways where "care" operates:

- we **take care** of stuff: objects, we manipulate them, we try to make them useful resources for our projects
- we **have care** for other human beings

Care means "cura", which is a Latin word that means, at the same time the effort, (laburiosity) and the concern.

When we are worried about something it is because it interests us, we try to take care of things, of our projects, and to push them to our goals.

Differently, we should not use the same care that we use for objects and stuff for human beings, because everyone has its own care, and it means that everyone has its own project, concerns and we should, while having care of others, use two different positions

- **rück-sicht**: the care that we should offer to other human beings where "rück" means "backwards"
- **nach-sicht**: "nacht" means "onwards".

Tools

The next step of civilization involves implanting not only this strength and energy into things but also **intelligence**, attributing something **spiritual** to it.

In this sense, the **homo digitalis**, that is the next step from the homo sapiens, not only makes things work for him, but also make them think.

With this **emancipatory** effect (something that makes us free, a promise to release us) of liberation from worry and care that digitalization offers a **way of life that is comparable to a game**.

The fact that, little by little, reality is replaced by virtual one, the price, the word that points at objects but **fill it with services**.

The lack of Greeks of attachment on the earthly order represented by things and objects gives way to the seductive likeness and fun of the game.

Today's man no longer has to rigorously overcome the resistance of material reality with this hard work, because the devices that he programmed take on the world while he can direct his processes as if it were again.

The human being online, no longer having objects to manipulate, loses the use of the hands, limiting himself to the use of fingers and if he hand is the organ of work and action as well, that is, as we have seen, strictly connected with the development of experience and intelligence, the **finger is the only organ of choice**.

Instead, he chooses to act choosing buttons to satisfy his needs without ever having to struggle and therefore being able to play.

Being in the net (in der web sein) brings us into a condition of Nihilism, as the things melt like hot wax and therefore can no longer can ever be possessed. More than possession, the contemporary area can be described as the **area of access**

Examples: Spotify, Netflix, AirBnB, ...

Boundaries and emotional ties to things, or places, or people are replaced by a temporary access to networks and platforms: the sharing economy weakens the identification with things that characterize possession, which is based on a stable and lasting vision of reality. We are constantly invited to **move on** and **not to identify ourself with something stable**.

In these platforms, even **our identities become products**: we produce ourselves in social media.

As we said, we put ourself on a stage to **form and perform our identity**: as identity becomes a product, life also takes on the form of a commodity, a merchandised product, while narration, reasoning, human judgement are replaced by likes.

Likes



What is a like? Not an opinion, it's an **agreement**. They do not represent an argumentative form of thinking, but **express a preference**, which has **no qualitative** content, measured only on the basis of their **quantity**.

The digital revolution does not only represent a change in the term of support, (the media that describes reality), but above all, the imposition of a new form of **culture**: that is **worship**, comes from "cult-". It's a cultural change.

We can detect a religious root in "culture": it is a worship and is a form of transmission of the **symbolic values** that are at the bottom, at the basis of a society and around which (these values) they form the community, because values are expressed in duration of time.

We can divide societies around different cultures, different worships:

- **archetypal society**: at the bottom of these values they have an **arché**, a principle that is up and above and must be respected
- **prototypical society**: when Nietzsche said "God is dead" he meant that there is no arché to rule our society but **we produce what we need for ourselves**, we produce prototypes, products, we do not expect from nature, from God, from providence to provide for us, we create them

- **stereotypical society**: today rooted in the digital age, which relies on the flattening all the difference in order to know and place everything on a shelf

The more the culture becomes a commodity, the more the idea of community is destroyed: the community is commodified for community, that is made up as we name them **digital swarms** (sciame digitali), that have no duration, no stability, no structure in which users can converge and disperse without anything that glue them together, apart from their desire and preference.

Instead of the community, the individual user and its profile are placed at the center of the digital culture: **no more community, but individual**.

Constant typing on the screens changed the way we perceive the world around us, which becomes tailored around us and follows our preference. Through the digital medium we are no longer thrown in the world, apparently the latter gives the impression of being entirely at its disposal.

Thanks to the use of IT devices, we are progressively eliminating the negativity that comes from others, and we try to reduce the coefficient of unavailability of throwness, something that does not depend on us, that is not available to us, of our existence.

"I" and "alter"

In the digital communications, the other human beings are less and less present: his otherness does not generate alteration in us, and therefore leave us identical to ourselves.

- **I (ego)**
- **alter (you)**

If I am not altered by you, it means that "I" becomes the center and expelled, because it does not encounter any difference nor limit.

Our identity is not something that is already given to us at the moment of our birth, but built with the other (alter) and sometimes even against others. Our being in the network protects us, shields us from the other, from his body and his gaze.

Even in the growing absence of corporeity, the digital communication, we can observe, **does not cancel the sense of community** that is inherent in us, but **mystifies it**, returning a distorted version of it, according to which the world becomes completely accessible and consumable.

So the other, therefore, has access to our narcissistic bubble to the extent that does not cause discomfort or alteration in us, we are the ones to decide whether to continue the

dialogue or dismiss it, to withdraw from the communication, banning and silencing those who resist us.

The platform, after all, does the same with us: if our expressions are classified as violating the guidelines, we are expelled and **reduced to silence**, and therefore **eliminated in our virtual existence**.

But resistance, if we think about it, is what allows our muscles to strain, to grow, it's resistance that test us: our muscles, our ideas, our thesis, ... and without resistance and opposition muscles do not grow but fat does.

Fat represents the implementation of the "same" ... our ego, without the resistance that is opposed by the "you" (alter), expands by feeding its own opinion, its ideas, and everything that does not prioritize our life. Apparently, this protective mode of being online should lead to a reduction of conflict and therefore expose us to less discomfort, but in fact we can observe the opposite happening: online, the production of our identities exacerbates our propensity for commensurate comparison (as Heidegger names it), so we look at the others as competition.

This system is built on the couple (**shame, pride**)

The experience of being online exposes us to the phenomenon of **hating**: a reaction implemented by the ego which is denied of speaking, a subject that can be violently silenced by algorithms without asking why.

The algorithm is not interested in "why", it just works and thing is, beside that, the discourse methodology presupposes the distinction between one's opinion and one's identity. But online, identity and opinion coincide, because there is no other existential sphere that one can refer to, and therefore one clings spasmodically to one's opinion, because otherwise also his identity would be in jeopardy.

Discourse, as Bruno Romano says, is based first and foremost on **listening**, but when it is lacking, the **discourse spaces becomes an echo chamber** but it's also **ego-chambers**, because it's a void place where our voice is returning.

Thanks to our device, it's possible for us to escape the presence of others, leaving otherselves alone in our digital bubbles where seemingly everything and everyone eats at our fingertip.

The inflation of communication through the digital medium is due precisely to this sense of emptiness, that the disappearance of the other produces and of which it is, at the same time, the effect and the cause.

The disappearing of the others (natural case) on me (the fact that we do not observe each other in real time) pushes us to expose ourselves online in a compulsive way: not doing that is equivalent to not being there, which is "not being"... the **FOMO phenomena** (Fear Of Missing Out).

Hence, the continuous and constant exposure of ourselves just like goods are displayed in a *gestell* accompanied by the need to continually renew what is exposed (we cannot post the same thing every day, we have to renew to give others attention high on us, just like for shops).

Manipulation of images

The idea that **digital pictures are not portraits anymore but they are product**: digital photography (and videos, gifs, ...) allow us to expose ourselves to others in a filtered way, to produce our image and not simply capture it.

Through a work of **manipulation of images**, we return this hyper real image of ourselves, that is beyond and outside reality: the possibility of manipulating images leads us to believe that our possibilities are enormously expanded and therefore that our freedom is increased by these technological means, but in this way we also see that in digital photography the **real reference is progressively eliminated**.

In fact, in selfies, the photographed subject is also the photographer: this connection between represented and real self increases the detachment between the individual person and the digital profile, and therefore leads us to an unauthentic relationship with others.

We can say that digital networks **lack the amphitheatral structure** that is in general based for the conventional **mass media**: when we see a TV or radio program we can see that it focuses on issues of general and social relevance and directs the attention of the public to these specific things, while the new media are made of centrifugal forces: this is the theme and the spectators are here, this is the center.

In the digital media, the centrifugal forces that inhabit the network cause the public sphere to break and fragment into these volatile swarms driven exclusively by personal interest: rather than converging on an issue that concerns the public sphere which requires a broad and stable perspective, not converging but diverging is encouraged, and hence diverging also becomes "divertimento", "distrarre", "distrazione", "distraction", in fact today we can observe somebody naming this the era of infotainment, which mixes up these two spheres.

Dialogue is that communicative act that is established between two subjects, while the **dialogical paradigm**, based on the discourse that is going around ("discorrere"), runs around, is breaking down online.

Through the others' discourse, we are positively distracted from ourself, from our beliefs. Only the voice of the others gives our work and our opinion a discursive quality that otherwise would be a monologue.

The expulsion of the other reinforces the construction of ourself and self indoctrination through our own ideas, so when the discourse that generates into information we witness prices of democracy, and those who dream of a society that is driven by algorithms consider politics a superfluous dimension and overcome by the efficiency of a managerial systems based on data.

Fifth Lesson

Heidegger and the Dictatorship of Mediocrity

Martin Heidegger's concept of the "dictatorship of mediocrity," first introduced in *Being and Time* as *das Man* (translated in Italian as "la dittatura del si"), refers not to a political regime but to an existential condition. In everyday life (*Alltäglichkeit*), human beings conform to impersonal norms; actions and beliefs are not authentically chosen but follow what "one does" (*man tut*), "one believes" (*man glaubt*), and "one says" (*man sagt*). This impersonal existence leads to self-alienation and a loss of authenticity—not out of laziness, but from surrendering to social conformity.

Dasein, Being-in-the-World, and Co-Existence

Heidegger defines human beings not by essence but through existence—*Dasein*, the being aware of its own being and mortality. *Dasein* always exists in relation to others (*Mitsein*) and within a world (*In-der-Welt-sein*), entangled with tools (*Zeug*) and fellow beings. This interconnection necessitates care (*Sorge*), which differs based on its object: instrumental toward tools, and ethical-moral toward others, expressed as *Rücksicht* (respect) and *Nachsicht* (compassion). Respect (*respicere*) sees the other as subject; compassion acts for the other without erasing their autonomy.

The Ambiguity of Care and the Problem of Substitution

Care, particularly in contexts of dependency, carries a dual nature: while it offers relief and support, it risks domination. Substitutional care can degrade into despotism, stripping others of agency. This expands the concept of power beyond institutions, grounding it in relationality and visibility.

Publicity, Visibility, and the Paradox of Exposure

Human beings are born into a condition of publicity—perpetually seen and judged. This exposure produces dual anxiety: the fear of being indistinct and the fear of standing out. It fuels comparison and internalizes power, making mediocrity self-perpetuating. Heidegger's "dictatorship of the average" is thus ontological, not merely sociological.

Alteration and the Phenomenology of Comparison

Using the metaphor of metal and water, Heidegger illustrates how humans are altered by others. *Alteration* (from *alter*, the other) implies transformation: humans are inherently intersubjective and comparative. Limited time and resources intensify this, promoting conformity and suppressing excellence.

The Role of Platforms and the Quantification of Meaning

Digital platforms reinforce this condition by emphasizing visibility through metrics—likes, shares, views. Popularity is favored over meaning, leading to hypervisibility that paradoxically conceals rather than reveals. Heidegger warns that "the overexposure of beings leads not to clarity, but to concealment." Phenomenology reminds us that true visibility requires contrast, shadow, and depth, which digital immediacy erodes.

Das Man in the Digital Age

Online life is increasingly governed by *das Man*—the impersonal crowd that thinks and acts for us. Algorithms generate replies (*Replik*), not genuine answers (*Antwort*), mediating experience and eliminating space for questioning. Authenticity, Heidegger argues, requires confronting *Angst* (existential anxiety), not *Furcht* (fear)—an anxiety born of finitude and possibility.

Power Beyond Law: Ontological Implications for Cyber Law

Power in the digital age is more than coercion or hierarchy—it is a mode of being. Every platform and algorithm expresses power. Law must be reconceived ontologically, not just juridically, as it increasingly involves questions about being, freedom, care, and responsibility in a world mediated by AI.

Authenticity and the Ethical Stakes of Technological Mediation

Authentic existence (*Eigentlichkeit*) demands confronting mortality and finitude. In contrast, the digital user defaults to inauthenticity (*Uneigentlichkeit*), where algorithmic predictions replace personal decisions. Machines "reply" from precedent, not experience. Human life involves doubt, interruption, and transformation—qualities absent from artificial logic.

The Dual Nature of Power: Capability and Domination

In Italian and other Romance languages, *potere* denotes both authority and capacity. This reveals power's ontological ambiguity: *Macht* (German) is not only about domination but also potentiality—*können*, the ability to act. Phenomenologically, power is dynamic, a relation between possibility and realization.

Macht and Herrschaft: Two Logics of Power

- *Macht**—from *machen* (to make)—embodies creative, relational power, akin to Heidegger's *entwerfen* (projection), shaping the world through initiative.
- *Herrschaft**—from *Herr* (lord)—evokes domination and hierarchy. It is patriarchal, commanding rather than creating. Silent domination aligns the will of the dominated with that of the dominator, achieving alienation disguised as consent.

The Fragility of Coercion: Violence as Weakness

Violence (*Gewalt*) is often mistaken for ultimate power, but force reveals power's failure. Coercion signals resistance. True power seduces, inviting and structuring rather than commanding. The more power depends on violence, the weaker it is. Violence collapses relation; it does not persuade, only destroys.

Persuasive Power in the Digital Age

Algorithmic systems rarely command; they suggest. Recommendation engines exert a "power of suggestion," merging freedom and domination. Platforms offer aid, not orders—seducing through comfort and convenience. This voluntary submission appears autonomous but occurs within externally framed structures.

Three Semantic Forms of Power

Drawing from phenomenology and semiotics (*σημαίνω*, to signify), power manifests in three symbolic forms:

The Power of the Sword (Schwertmacht):

Sovereigns and martyrs wield this vertical, theatrical power. It speaks through violence, spectacle, and decree—liturgical, visible, and fearful.

The Power of the Law (Gesetzesmacht):

This power is mediated by *logos*. It derives authority from consensus and normative structures, operating horizontally through trust, pacts, and procedures. Though it may bear the sword, its primary mode is symbolic and deliberative.

The Power of Habit (Gewohnheitsmacht):

The most insidious form, habit-based power naturalizes routines until they become unquestioned. Heidegger's *öffentliche Auslegung* (public interpretation) describes this silent normalization. Power here becomes invisible, embedded in defaults, scrolls, and daily interactions.

From Apparatus to Ontology: Platform Power

The digital *Gerät* (apparatus) becomes a world unto itself. Algorithms shift power from delegation to substitution. Technology no longer assists—it replaces. Decision-making,

doubt, and even error are outsourced. The danger lies not in misuse but in overuse: the slow erosion of agency through excess mediation.

Time, Labor, and Contemplation

Platform capitalism colonizes time: productivity invades leisure, and idleness is treated as inefficiency. Yet traditions—particularly Zen and Heidegger’s *Gelassenheit*—affirm the resistance in “doing nothing.” Rest, wonder, and stillness become forms of resistance to time’s monetization.

The Silent Drift Toward Domination

As power becomes more integrated, it grows invisible. It no longer forbids—it offers. The user experiences freedom without realizing that options are preformatted, framed by invisible architectures. Domination appears as design. The default becomes destiny, and totalizing ease replaces authentic choice.

Sixth lesson

Truth and transparency



Truth is not only seen in a philosophical, hermeneutical way, but related to our nowadays online life, so fake news and the **Post Truth Era** (in italian, era della post-verità).

Our present time can be seen as an era of digital nihilism. We must now try to understand how this time of information and data is responsible for the affirmation of this nihilism

and how this is connected to the concept of truth, that today is a synonymous of **transparency**.

So truth and transparency are concepts that are frequently recalled in the average everyday life (**mediality**), but despite their frequent use, and indeed precisely because of this, they are often misunderstood in their original meaning and this leads to trivialization and possible distorted use.

Networks and platforms in our daily lives have changed the way we understand our identity, the relationship with others, and the perception of **time** and **space**. Being on the net, in the **WEB-SEIN**, influences our way of forming obedience, how we cultivate our beliefs, how we structure them in our theories and also our way of understanding the **truth** and to relate to it. Let's consider the word the truth.

What is the truth?

Some related concepts: what we can see; relativity; mathematics; verifiable; objectivity; dogma.

But there is something wrong already in the question: what is THE truth? In fact, it seems that truth is something given in front of our eyes, but it's more dynamic than a set of data.

In the Christian culture, the truth is what will set you free, and after all, is the only possible definition of truth, and that is not a fact to assume, but what calls you to something else, something that can change you (**transformative experience**).

Assimilating truth to scientific certainty is a modern tendency, which arises from the human need to take possession of the world and to dominate it to dispose it in a **GESTELL**, a shelf, a structure and use it as a **BESTAND**, something where we keep our stuff and used when needed.

Secondary type truth

These **secondary type of truths** are based on criteria on which we agree. Are there any criteria to establish what the truth is? There are no absolute ones. They are always connected to the time that we live in, but also to the goal that we are pursuing, and to the question that we ask and how we ask this question.

We already have criteria at our disposal that we use since the day we were born. These criteria **shape** our thinking and frame what we observe in a general understanding. There are some doors to pursue truth and our era, our culture, our paradigmas that we have at our disposal, on the basis of which we decide **what truth is**.

Example of truth in 16th century

For example, in the 16th century, there were considered to be witches, and there were codes and process to determine if somebody was a witch or not and important because they were regulated very strictly, and they could lead to be sent to death. So, if they found out that somebody was a witch, he was the truth.

Truth in a secondary sense

We can talk about truth in a **secondary sense**: $2 + 2 = 4$ and not 7. But we cannot apply these statements that can be proven through available criteria to the problem of criteria itself, the problem of the meaning that we want to inscribe in our actions and in our existence.

In the same way, we can't establish with positive scientific criteria, what justice is, once and for all. So for example, during the pandemic, how to decide who should occupy hospital beds? The elder, the youngest, the poorest? How can we program these unprogrammable choices also with programmable machines?

Recognize the truth

All the truth that really concerns us cannot be demonstrated scientifically, but must be searched through other channels. These channels are those of the **internal dialog** and **dialog with others**.

The truths that we can scientifically demonstrate serve us for purposes. For example, we know that water boils at 100 degrees, but the purposes, the goals are much more complicated. So what do we listen to? What do **we trust**? How do we spot the truth in the end? We can say that the truth could be considered what corresponds to my **experience**, that is from an hermeneutical point of view, what we **recognize** to be true, but we can never know directly.

Recognize comes from **RE-CONOSCERE** (or **CONOSCERE**).

Conoscere is something that we love straight away, while reconoscere means "something that calls my experience".

Interpretation of facts

What is scandalous about this idea of truth that can be recognized but not known directly? There are no facts, but only **interpretation of facts**. The facts must be stated by somebody, because they cannot speak for themselves. We are always already placed in a perspective that does not depend exclusively on us and that we have not chosen. Heidegger names it **Geworfenheit**: we don't decide when we are born, or where we are born...

So, the truth can only be accessed individually: we have access to individual truths, as those of the carriages, the mathematics, the physics, or psychology, but the horizon that constitutes the general meaning of truth is a more complex situation.

Among all these different interpretations, what position should we take? We have to adopt the most legitimate criteria for the specific situation. If someone asks us if there are witches or vampires in this room, we answer no, but we have never done a test to verify it. And we don't do it because this horizon is simply consumed.

The interpretation of facts is accused to be contrary to the facts, contrary to reality: what you can touch with your hands seems more persuasive in the sense that it is something easier to agree on.

Truth as inter subjective relationship

Truth is a matter of **inter subjective relationship**. Also the scientific experiment must be expressed in the mathematical characters, in a language that is unique and as universal as possible, so that everyone can review the experiment, and we call it **ARGUMENTUM AD HOMINEM**. In other words, if others want to repeat the experiment and reach the same result, they agree and say "This is the truth".

So truth is something that should be seen more connected to the relationship with others than to the relationship with the objective data.

For example, when I need to place a picture on the wall, I need another person beside me. But if the picture is aligned or not, I need somebody else from another perspective to say that has to have the same criteria that I have, but has to be external. Therefore, the truth is not only the scientific certainty, the full knowledge and the control over an entity.

So let's make a stupid example. I have an appointment with a friend and I'm late, and he writes to me "where are you?". If I want to tell the truth, I cannot answer by reporting every detail about my position: "I'm in Europe", "I'm in Italy", "I'm in Rome" because he wants to know how long he has to wait for me, basically. So he doesn't want a complete description of all the things that surround me. I cannot describe everything in order to say the truth. For this reason, we need an **interpretation**.

Truth and interpretation are not antithetical, because truth is not opposed to interpretation, but it's made up of it. Like justice, truth is not something that already exists in nature, but it has to pass through the human work of searching for the meaning that needs a shared language and a dialog.

Truth and lie

Truth is connected also with **lie**. We have two parts:

- **Veritas**, also called **naked truth (nuda verità)**. Here the truth meets the lie and they begin to dialog;
- **Lie**.

So, truth and lie start to dialogue and lie convinces the truth to take a bath in the pit. But as soon as the truth undresses, the lie steals the clothes and runs away in town, introducing himself as the truth. Truth, having come out of the pit to recollect the clothes, she returns naked to the village and she will be seen with contempt by the man, and will be forced to return to the pit where she will hide forever. Whoever wants to look for truth will then have to be ready to lean into the pit and to look **deeply**.

Heidegger would say that we have to face the **anguish** that separates those who travel on the surface of every day in authenticity and those who face the abroad that is the abyss of nothingness.

Thus lie, when dressed like truth, becomes **plausible**. And the truth can become a **scandal**. But it's better a well dressed lie than a scandalous truth. Lie does not have the courage to enter into the pit, but the truth does. For this, we consider truth something **transformative**, an **experience**. The truth in this sense is calling us and we should respond distancing ourself from lie. Looking at the bottom of the pit, we can see the truth that it's into and also our reflection. This is our interpretation.

There is another legend. The godness of naked truth has a mirror in his hand and this is even clearer how the reflection of those who are seeking the truth does not disappear but they enter as an **integral part of the picture**.

The nature of the truth

The nature of truth is not that of full **exposure** or **appearance**, but that of **subtraction**. The godness of truth prefers to hide.

In greek, truth is **ἀλήθεια (alètheia)** and we can divide it in different ways. It can have two different rules:

- **ἀλή**, that means **footprint**. It is the footprints of the gods (**θεία**), that is something dynamic.
- The second possibility is represented by the greek word **λανθάνω**, that means hide myself. It means that we are brought out of hiding. We reveal.

So the center is the hiding and the researching activity, that is not following the footsteps of a path but bringing things out of their hiding. And it's what **technique** of human beings does: produce something.

Contemplation

The environment, the others are no longer seen in a **contemplative** way, but in a **manipulative** one, so for what they can be used. **Contemplate** means to watch something and not desiring to use it.

Things are conducted, directed and forced by men, that for Heidegger is the **shepherd** of being toward his hands, his needs and his projects.

For example let's consider a good. The good is regarded in an **instrumental** way. So as a reserve, a shelter and so on. So it's not a source of poetry.

Transparency and appearance

Our ego, to exist on the net, is continuously called to expose itself through the voluntary and involuntary sharing of personal data. We are called to expose our inner world to make a content out of it.

Transparency is the phenomenological opposite of **appearance**. Phenomenology inquires phenomena as they appear.

Appear is the synonym of **to seem**. For example, when we say "I appear younger than I am". On the other hand, to appear means that I start **to be**. Let's consider a flu: it appears initially as very small symptoms. So it can go in another way.

Transparency wants to enter violently into the thing and to see things from inside.

According to Heidegger, this procedure that tends to unveil the truth without revealing it as the lie near the pit is a violent way of treating it without **care**. And care is how human beings deal with other entities and with other human beings.

Nachsicht and rücksicht

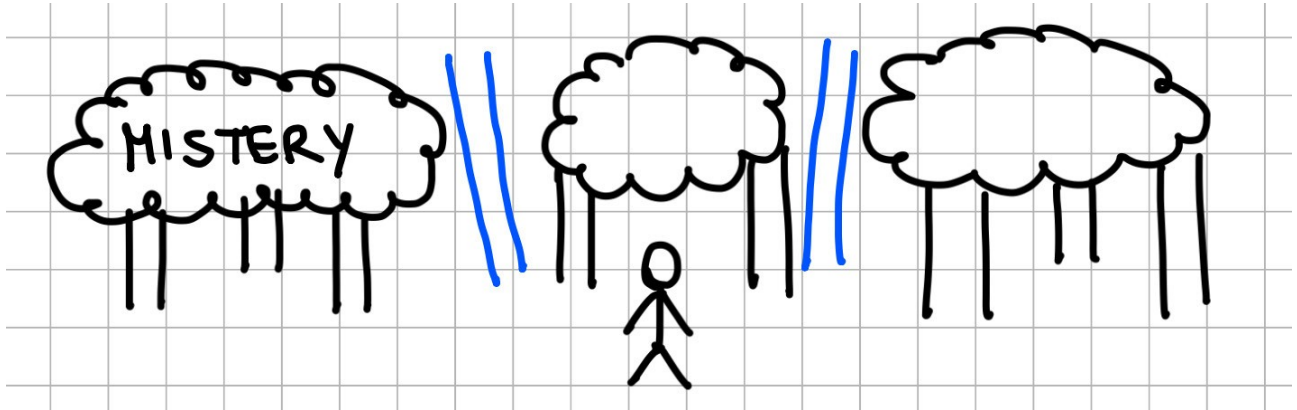
The care has to have two different movements:

- **NACHSICHT**, that is the benevolent approach: we want to be helpful;
- **RUCKSICHT**, that means that we adopt a respectful distance to observe something, not in a violent way.

So this idea of truth as a full **exposure** is opposed to the higher idea of truth as **clearing**, as **lichtung** (in italian, **radura**).

Lichtung

The **lichtung** (a clearing) is seen as the root of the world.



The idea is that truth is a clearing. When we walk in the woods and the vegetation is very thick, it does not allow us to see through. But at the certain point where the trees out, a clearing emerges when the light filters through the vegetation and illuminates a small stretch of the path.

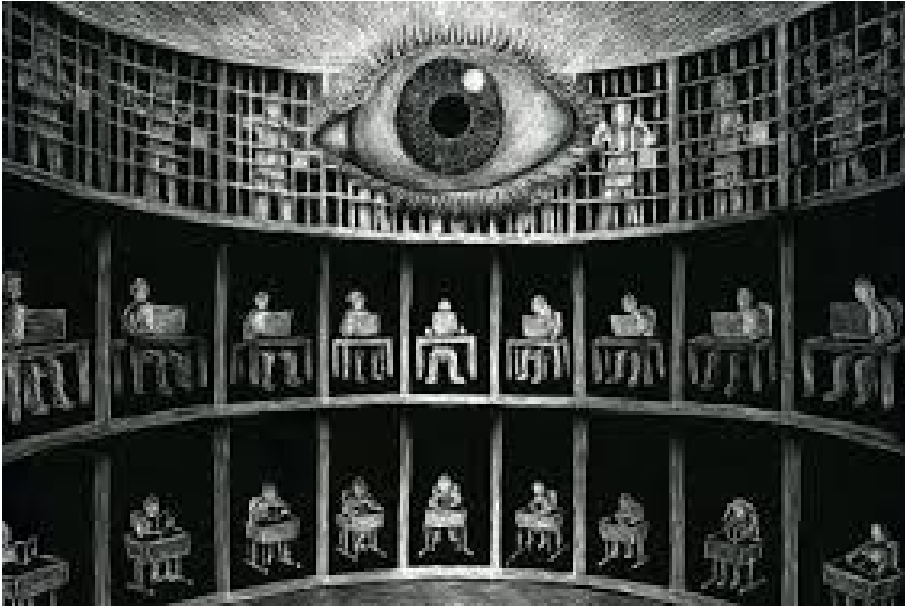
We can admire a wider and clearer panorama than what we saw in the shade of the tall thick trees. So men move through their existence, that is this thick blanket of the **unknown**.

What does it mean **light**? In German, it's **LICHT**. In Italian it has two meanings: **luce** and **leggero**. And it maintains this ambiguity: it's used to enlight or to make space.

Light allows us to see the things and the clearing makes space for the thing to appear. Truth is never something already given, but it's something to be found, to be captured. But it's an activity of interpretation, a crack of light that opens up the **mystery** of being, without dissipating it completely.

This idea of truth is considerably far from today declination of truth which is increasingly linked to the idea of transparency. While it is contrary to its democratic connotation, transparency has become a tool of control in the hands of corporations and governments. So surveillance technologies monitor and regulate behaviors while the illusion of transparency obscures the true extent of power dynamics at play.

Digital panopticon



Users are encouraged to share every aspect of their lives, creating a **digital panopticon**.

Individuals subject themselves to the constant exposure for social recognition, approval and validation. And this is where surveillance takes root and flourishes.

In a society obsessed with **self exposure**, genuine human connection is becoming increasingly rare. The constant performance of the self leaves very little room for **empathy** and for understanding others while it encourages **competition** and shame.

Social network are based on **competition** and **shame**. The show of transparency is a show that while showing everything can be exposed takes the meaning out of it and lets it empty and something can only be transparent when it's empty.

Stories

Let's think about the narratives, the stories, the legends that create an **intergenerational dialogue** and so an intergenerational continuity. If we think about it, narratives and stories have moved online where we have these digital **stories**. These are made by strangers. And they become familiar to us without ever coming into contact with our existence. So they enter in our daily lives through the **infotainment**: information and entertainment.

But the stories are not addressed precisely to us but to unknown users and they are not authentic because they are not disinterested. There is no free transmission of experiences because they are tamed. They have the poison of the commercial

purposes. So the storyteller is also a liar: another connection between truth and lie.

The act of sharing loses its original meaning of a shared participation in the existence of the others to become a ghostly presence rendered in the form of unilateral transmissions of content.

Noise

It is clear that phenomenologically the fact that communication is now increasingly in the hands of the **masses**. It also has extremely positive aspects. Not least the fact that we want to know about certain realities, thanks to the lack of information. However, we must remember that more information does not necessarily lead to better information and sometimes it also ends up paralyzing the faculties of judgment. It's called **noise**.

When we have too much data and we cannot process them, a huge amount of information does not produce any truth. It does not bring light in the darkness, but rather it becomes **darkness** itself. From a certain point on, information is no longer **informative**, but it's **deformative**.

Truth and lies online wear the same suits, have the same clothes, those of information. Let's think about the fake news. The purpose is not to communicate. They have an **addiction** objective, and not a **communicative** one.

Addiction indicates that the purpose is to create vicious cycles and to dope information. Fake news are not lies. But it is much more dangerous to the truth. They are not opposite of the truth, they are indifferent to the truth.

Trust

We all know that the generative AI can today create image content videos that perfectly mimic reality leading us to doubt what we see.

So this crisis of truth underlines a very important concept: **trust**. In particular, **trust in facts**. In the digital panopticon no trust is possible and it's not necessary. Trust becomes an obsolete effort when information is easily available online. So trust as a social practice increasingly loses meaning and instead we let control run free through our private lives.

The **society of transparency** has a structural proximity with the society of surveillance. Surveillance society presents a peculiar panoptical structure.

Panopticon

The philosopher Bentham presented his idea of **panopticon**, that is a form of prison and it consists in cells that are isolated from each other preventing the inmates from communicating with each other. The inhabitants of the digital panopticon connect and communicate intensively with each other.

In the traditional **panopticon**, we have a guard in the center that can look at everybody in their cells, but the inmates in their cells cannot see each other. They can only see the guard. And the guard can see them all. And you only need one guard for all the reason.

Pan means **all**.

The **digital panopticon** removes the walls so the inmates can interact. This is interesting because the guard can see the behavior. When we are isolated, it's impossible to describe us because we are firstly social creatures. So to understand deeply the human nature, you have to see our interaction. Total control is made possible not by a special and communicative isolation but by network connection and communication.

The inhabitants of the digital panopticon are not prisoners. They live in the **illusion of freedom**. They feed the panopticon with information voluntarily exposing and illuminating themselves adopting a form of **self exploitation**.

Self exploitation is more effective than that exercised by the others because it goes with a feeling of freedom. So it seems to be our choice. The society of control is fully achieved where its inhabitants expose themselves not out. **Freedom and control become one**.

Some reflections

The movie "The hole" is a metaphor of how our society runs today. The fact that people change the floor on which they are on is a lucky event. But people cannot really go higher than their social class. And if they can, it is just like one step above.

Like in finance, you can invest and you have a sudden shift, but if you cannot manage your money because you're not born in a family that taught you it's likely that you will become poor again in the next year.

In the movie, there is no empathy: on the table they put enough food or lettuce and nobody shares with the other. So it's a division of wealth and nobody shares with others. Everybody thinks only what's better for themselves and nobody wants to share.

The lack of cooperation among human beings is what is degrading society. And it's one of the main concepts that the movie also wants to highlight, and it's the base of **capitalism**.

In the movie, they believe that they will go because they needed to believe that someone controls everything that was happening around them but they could not understand. So people had this need to not blame it but explain it somehow, without thinking that they're in this random world. It's really important to also look at what is behind the things, because some people would act differently if they felt a certain need that we don't know.

Capitalism can be seen as a metaphor. So there is a bird called **cuculo**, that has this survival strategy: it drops the eggs in a nest of another bird that has similar eggs. When the eggs open the little of the cuculo is much bigger and chases all the others and so becomes like the prayer. And so, **capitalism is the egg of the cuculo in the nest of Christianity**. So capitalism can be seen as a parasite.

Seventh lesson

Truth in Three Societies

Truth does not simply describe something objective; it is recognized through shared interpretative canons, forms of intersubjective validation. It is not about what is *objectively* true, but how we agree to interpret reality.

We explored three societal models that frame our understanding of truth:

1. **Archetypal Society** : *Arche* means principle. Here, truth comes from the word of God. Yet, as divine words require interpretation, truth is inevitably mediated through interpreters (such as priests) who shape it through their aims and worldviews.
2. **Prototypical Society**: Based on production and technology. Here, truth follows the scientific paradigm: it must be measurable, demonstrable, and verifiable.
3. **Stereotypical Society**: *Stereo* in Greek implies rigidity, fixedness. It is the society of the network, where all behavior is translated into data. Every action becomes information, stripped of narrative coherence. Information lacks depth and sequence. It is fast, fragmented, and forward-looking.

Information vs. Narration

Narration assembles voices like a choir, building coherence and a sense of time. Information, instead, overwhelms us with a flood of disconnected data, creating background noise. This does not enhance our awareness, it disperses it. On platforms where everyone has the same voice, authority becomes elusive. The result is a flattening of discourse.

In the stereotypical society, truth becomes synonymous with **transparency**. But transparency is not illumination. Full exposure can blind us. The paradox is that visibility might hide more than it reveals.

Truth and Transparency

Truth, unlike information, proceeds by **subtraction**, it reveals itself by withdrawing. Transparency implies seeing through something. But this capacity does not belong only to the object. It involves the observer. The boundary between inside and outside becomes irrelevant only because we are looking through it. Transparency, therefore, is not neutral.

Identity and Apparition

Online, existence is no longer enough. To be online, one must be *appariscente* (striking, flashy). The self does not appear through spontaneous co-presence but is deliberately constructed and exhibited, often filtered, sometimes falsified. Online identities become **products**, curated for visibility.

Influencers demonstrate this shift. The most compelling figures today are not those who project perfection, but those who appear “authentic,” evoking empathy and emotional engagement. The appearance of imperfection has become the new currency of influence.

Commodification of Vulnerability

This dynamic gives rise to critical phenomena:

- **Sharenting**: the commercialization of parenting. Children become media content, consumed as mass products.
- **Charity capitalism**: vulnerability as entertainment. Known as "charity porn", this exposes suffering to provoke engagement.
- **Capitalism of pain**: illness and death are normalized and monetized, raising concerns about dignity and ethical care.

In these cases, discomfort may become a source of validation and attention. This creates feedback loops where identities are built around suffering, making recovery more difficult. Visibility replaces intimacy. To be viewed is not the same as to be *seen*.

Fragmented Realities and Digital Solitude

The digital space has dismantled the notion of a shared horizon. We live in personalized bubbles, impermeable and self-reinforcing. Events no longer dictate collective time, we consume content individually, detached from communal rhythm.

There is a paradox of **contactless connection**: we are alone, yet visible to many. We exist in a state of *hyper-invaded solitude* or a *hyper-isolated multitude*. The other does not disappear, but becomes a product, displayed like merchandise on a shelf.

Digital crowds do not aggregate around ideology or shared purpose. Unlike the physical “mass” of the past, the digital swarm is anonymous, rootless, and ideologically empty. It is driven by individual preferences and consumer satisfaction.

Performing Connection

New forms of performance emerge. For example, a girl livestreams herself studying, doing nothing but reading. Every 30 minutes, she checks in with viewers. This non-performance fulfills a deep human need: presence. But the presence is mediated: there is no contact, only connection.

We are constantly in relation, yet untouched. The result is a reduction of being—not fully alone, not truly together. What emerges is not intimacy, but spectacle.

The Emotional Economy of the Network

Even though we act rationally in online spaces, our motivations, desires, passions, projects remain deeply emotional. Content must stimulate *emotions*: surprise, amusement, outrage, pain. These reactions feed engagement, **activating dopamine circuits**. Emotional content becomes the lever for attention and, therefore, value.

What begins as exploration becomes permanence. The network is no longer a space we visit, it becomes a place we inhabit. We work, relate, protect ourselves within it. But what seems like freedom is, in truth, shaped by invisible, pervasive forces. This power is not aggressive, but subtle and systemic.

Transparency as Control

We previously saw how truth in stereotypical society aligns with *transparency*. This continues into the power structures of digital life. Transparency is a moral imperative today, invoked as an unquestioned good. Yet it raises profound problems for privacy, dignity, and rights.

In the disciplinary regime, the dynamics of visibility were entirely different. Visibility, as illustrated by the panopticon, was achieved not through connection, but through **isolation**. The subject was rendered visible by being confined, physically restricted within a designated space, where solitude ensured they could always be observed.

Today, by contrast, **digital technology transforms communication into surveillance**. The more we communicate, the more data we generate, and the more efficient surveillance becomes. What is perceived as a space of freedom is, in fact, the foundation of a new regime of control.

Domination reaches its highest form when **freedom and surveillance coincide**. Unlike the past, visibility is no longer imposed from outside—it is *chosen*. Individuals are not forced into the spotlight; they voluntarily step into it, driven by a deep need to share, to connect, to be seen. They stage themselves, perform their identity, and offer their lives as content.

In this **informational regime**, people pursue the visibility that prisoners in the disciplinary regime once feared and fled. Where inmates once tried to hide from the gaze, users now compete to enter it. The relationship has been completely reversed.

This strategy of visibility, **called transparency**, becomes the new form of systemic coercion. In the information society, everything must exist as data. And **transparency demands the unrestricted circulation of information**.

But ultimately, it is not human beings who are truly free, **information is**.

Architecture of Power

Two architectural symbols reflect this shift:

- The **Apple Store**: all glass, no clear boundary between inside and outside. Movement is open, objects can be touched. A “temple of transparency.”
- The **conclave** or the **Ka’ba**: sacred, inaccessible. Veiled in mystery and separation.

Despite its openness, the Apple Store hides the real centers of power—engineers, data centers—just like sacred inner sanctums were once accessible only to priests.

Transparency, therefore, is a surface illusion; it conceals more than it reveals.

Digital Tools and Mimicry

Another key to digital dominance is **mimesis**, the capacity to disguise as something else. Smart devices, apps, voice assistants blend into everyday life, appearing as helpful tools. Their strength lies in their **gratuitousness**, but this “free” is never truly free.

We must distinguish between two types of gratuity:

- The first is *genuine*, like care within families or friendship.
- The second is *instrumental*: it costs nothing upfront but requires something later—data, time, identity.

This new regime no longer uses force. It operates through **motivation and incentive**, not obligation or punishment.

Capitalism as Cult

We now begin our inquiry into capitalism—not merely as an economic system but as a *religion*, following Walter Benjamin's reflections.

Benjamin identified three characteristics of capitalism as religion:

1. **Purely Cultic:** No dogma or theology, only continuous ritual. Capitalism is a culture built on unceasing worship of production and consumption.
2. **Perpetual:** No rest days, no holidays. 24/7 productivity, demanding constant engagement without pause.
3. **Produces Guilt, Not Redemption:** Unlike traditional religions that promise forgiveness, capitalism manufactures guilt and debt. It does not relieve, it *accumulates*.

Today, the **consumer** replaces the producer as the center of capitalist ideology. The logic of **globalization** presents growth as an unquestionable goal, creating a new form of untouchable ideology masked as neutrality.

Neo-Management and Human Cost

Within this new system, **management** becomes a performance. It is no longer about *knowing* how to do something, but about *being someone*. Originality is demanded, yet systematically neutralized.

Recruitment is no longer based purely on competence, but on one's **persona**, the “spark” that can serve the company. This results in deep intrusion into the private self.

The more the company asks for authenticity, the more individuals pour their emotional and existential resources into their roles. This creates a **cycle of debt**, not just financial, but emotional and existential.

Cracks are appearing. Emotional fatigue, burnout, and fragile relationships are widespread. Even within the most “successful” companies, individuals are collapsing under the weight of their own performance.

The Ideological Framework of Capitalism

Contemporary capitalism presents itself as *neutral*, but beneath this appearance lie two foundational dogmas: **meritocracy** and **incentive**. These principles frame an ideology of *neo-management*, where the manager is not simply a skilled operator, but a figure to be *performed*.

The emphasis is not on know-how, but on *being someone*. This "someone" must display originality, yet paradoxically, true originality is incompatible with the system, it threatens standardization.

Recruitment no longer focuses solely on competence, but on personal traits, on a spark, a presence, an energy that can be *used*. The workplace increasingly intrudes on private life, dissolving the boundary between the personal and professional self.

The Emotional Exploitation of Workers

Managers and workers are no longer asked for effort alone—they are asked for **soul**. Companies use intimate, emotional codes—esteem, loyalty, sacrifice, passion—not to honor the human being, but to *extract more* from them.

This is the **great scam** of late capitalism: it mimics the language of community, but strips it of depth. It takes the emotional codes of family, religion, or even military service, and weaponizes them for productivity.

Whereas older institutions demanded much, they *earned* that sacrifice by standing for something greater—community, faith, nation. Today's corporations exploit the **language of belonging** without offering its substance.

Sacrifice Without Community

The manager is asked to give up time, passion, priorities, often erasing the boundary between work and life. If corporations were to genuinely recognize the *gift* of this existential investment, they would need to build *true* communities.

But this is precisely what they resist. Real community implies **reciprocity**, **fragility**, and **care**, things difficult to control. Thus, authentic gratuity becomes a threat. It cannot be measured, owned, or monetized.

The Narcissistic Pact

There is a *mirroring contract* between youth and corporations. The successful company sees itself reflected in the young manager, and the manager in turn projects themselves into the company. This *narcissistic entanglement* consumes young lives, offering recognition in exchange for identity.

It echoes ancient sacrificial practices, where youth were offered to gods. Today's altar is the *meeting room*, and the ritual is performed without rest.

Quiet Quitting and the Rise of Passive Resistance

A new form of resistance emerges: **quiet quitting**. It is not a revolt but a retreat. The employee, underpaid and undervalued, performs the bare minimum, conserving effort and emotion.

Quiet quitting is a **passive protest** against an economic system that demands everything but offers little in return. It challenges the idea that *sacrifice equals merit* when recognition is missing.

Capitalism as Anti-Religion

Some reflections reveal capitalism as an **anti-religion**. Unlike traditional religions that seek to elevate and redeem, capitalism generates guilt and sin—without the promise of absolution.

Its worst sin is **poverty**. To be poor is not just a misfortune, but a moral failure in this system. And unlike ancient religions that punished communally, capitalism punishes *individually*. There are no people, no tribe to support you, only isolation.

The logic moves us from **communities** to **commodities**. What once connected now consumes. The sacrificial altar is smooth, sterile, and optimized.

Eighth Lesson

Two Christian Roots of Capitalism

Modern capitalism in the West has developed along two main religious-cultural axes within Christianity. On one side, the North American and North European tradition—deeply influenced by Protestantism—establishes a clear dichotomy between the "City of God" and the "City of Man." This framework justifies the separation of personal morality from economic activity, crystallizing in the notion that "business is business."

On the other hand, the Latin Mediterranean model—rooted in Catholicism—blends these two spheres more fluidly. Here, personal, familial, and communal values intermingle with economic behavior. As a result, the economy is populated with cooperative ventures, family businesses, nonprofit enterprises, and social enterprises where the line between public and private interest is less defined.

The Protestant Ethic and the Spirit of Capitalism

Max Weber famously argued that modern capitalism owes its cultural infrastructure to Calvinist Protestantism. In this worldview, *Beruf*—a German word meaning both "profession" and "vocation"—is central. One's professional labor is seen as a divine calling, and worldly success is interpreted as a sign of God's grace. Consequently, rigorous work ethic is not just encouraged but spiritualized.

Another central trait of this system is the disciplined approach to wealth: instead of indulging in consumption, Calvinist cultures favored accumulation and reinvestment of capital. This mindset catalyzed industrial development and laid the groundwork for the rise of modern finance. The spiritual imperative to save and invest helped transform capital into a self-replicating force, central to capitalism as we know it.

Market, Soul, and the Religious Logic of Capital

Within this logic, the market is no longer merely a site of exchange; it becomes an ethical and almost religious space. It incubates virtues and moral values and shapes daily life. Thus, the link between "soul and money" becomes internalized. The market becomes a kind of spiritual arena, turning economic activity into an expression of one's inner virtue.

The Rise and Retreat of the Welfare State

In reaction to the inequalities of early capitalism, the 20th century introduced the welfare state—an effort, particularly in postwar Europe, to reduce social disparities through massive public investment in shared goods such as education, healthcare, and social security. This investment was quantified by metrics like PIL (*Prodotto Interno Lordo*, or GDP), which represents the total value of goods and services produced in society.

Thanks to these investments, significant strides were made in civil rights: access to education, gender equality, labor protections, and universal healthcare. Yet, while the public sphere pursued justice, behind the scenes an anti-egalitarian counterrevolution was brewing, driven by multinational corporations, business schools, and global consultancy firms. This movement aimed to re-legitimize inequality through a new moral framework.

Meritocracy and the Ethical Justification of Inequality

Central to this new capitalist creed is the concept of merit. Merit becomes the moral excuse for economic inequality, positing that income disparities reflect differences in talent—talent bestowed, ultimately, by divine providence. Poverty, then, is recast not as a social failure but as personal fault or even divine punishment.

However, this narrative is deeply problematic. Merit is not neutral; it is defined by power. Companies and institutions decide what counts as "meritorious" based on their objectives, reducing the breadth of human talent to narrow, measurable traits. As a result, individuals are either promoted into an elite "aristocracy" or left behind in a replaceable underclass—like interchangeable parts in a machine. Heidegger's notion of the "dictatorship of mediocrity" is apt here, as true human qualities such as humility, compassion, and mercy are excluded from the calculus of value.

From the Worker to the Consumer: A Shift in Capitalist Theology

Where early capitalism venerated the worker—the sacred figure of production—contemporary capitalism worships the consumer. Consumption replaces production as the center of the system. Work becomes invisible; speculative finance, promising profits without effort, rises in its place. The modern economy praises those who consume, not those who create.

This shift has disintegrated the communal aspect of economic life. Historically, consumption had a social dimension—evident in marketplaces where goods and, more importantly, words were exchanged. But today's consumption is solitary, often conducted

online and mediated only by algorithms. It satisfies desires without requiring effort or social engagement—embodying the capitalist slogan: "Unlimited enjoyment."

The Disintegration of Community

Consumption, being individualistic, undermines *communitas* (from *cum* + *munus*), which signifies both shared obligation and collective gift. In the past, community meant both giving one's talents to others and being bound by reciprocal duties. Now, as production and cooperation fade, and consumption dominates, the community as a lived social structure dissolves.

Heidegger described this dissolution as "ontic sleep," a condition where individuals are numbed by routine and detached from authentic being-with-others. As traditional forms of community fade, capitalism paradoxically tries to rebuild them—through brand-based "market communities" such as fans of a clothing label or motorcycle group. But these new tribes are structured not around values or mutual care, but around objects.

Idolatry, Sacrifice, and the New Religious Order

In this transformed spiritual economy, capitalism becomes not merely religious but idolatrous. At its center stands a "totem"—a lifeless symbol that demands sacrifices from its followers but offers nothing in return. This recalls the concept of brood parasitism (cuckoo), where the totem (capitalism) consumes the energy of others without contributing to their life.

Sacrifice, originally a sacred offering to animate beings or noble ideals, becomes exploitation when made to entities that cannot reciprocate—such as companies or markets. Even institutions born from gratuitousness, like schools or hospitals, are now subject to instrumental logic and economic metrics. Their original gift-nature is devoured by financial rationality.

The Taboo of the Gift

In a culture organized around profit, gratuitousness is capitalism's greatest threat. It destabilizes the logic of transaction and control. A real gift (*dono*)—unlike a conditional "*regalo*" that often hides a motive—is subversive because it reintroduces the sacred, the unmeasured, and the relational into a system obsessed with calculability.

Capitalism, sensing this threat, deploys "homeopathic" gratuitousness: fake generosity in the form of small gifts (free trials, reward points) meant to immunize against true

relational giving. But these are empty gestures. True gifts, rooted in gratuitousness, aim not at objects but at deep intersubjectivity. They are grounded in trust, not envy.

Storytelling, Branding, and the Commodification of Meaning

To sustain its structure, capitalism has appropriated the very tools once used to build culture—narration, symbols, myth. Modern marketing does not merely present products; it tells stories. These narratives aim to activate deep symbolic codes within the consumer, creating emotional bonds that mimic the meaning of traditional myths—but toward the goal of profit.

In traditional communities, storytelling (as in fairy tales passed from grandparents to children) was an act of pure gratuitousness—conveying wisdom, hope, and liberation. By contrast, capitalist storytelling is manipulative. It activates emotions artificially to induce desire, envy, and shame. The result is a simulated community based not on shared meaning but on shared consumption.

Ninth lesson

Capitalism

We can observe **capitalism** from different POVs. To do this we can use:

- 1) **phenomenology**, that describes the phenomena of capitalism as it appears to us;
- 2) **hermeneutics**, that allows us to study the words, understanding how they changed, losing their original meaning.

We can describe the capitalism with two world:

- **CARE** (in italian, **CURA**);
- **FEAST** (in italian, **FESTA**, or also CELEBRATION, HOLIDAY)

These words are very important for the spiritual life and the economical one, because there is no care without celebration and there is no feast without care.

The **care** is at the center of the economy, the religious life and also the feast, the holiday has influenced the economic and spiritual category. The goal of our capitalism is to transform the holiday into **entertainment**.

Capitalism wants to transform the feast into a commodity that can be purchased on the market.

Care

Heidegger said that care is the fundamental way on how human beings relate to things and to others. This is because we take care of things allowing them to work and also we take care of the others to leave them the freedom.

So there is a profound relationship between spirituality, interiority and care. And also between the language and the word of care and the language and the word of religious and spiritual life.

For example, **temples** and **time** share a common root. When you cross the threshold of the temple (a church, a monastery), you become a little bit a master of time. So you don't feel anymore dominated by the rational time of efficiency.

You can travel more freely floating in a time that is not oriented towards any purpose. But this experience has no meaning if within us there is no room for the **LICHTUNG**, so the illumination that can break the laws of rational time.

So we have to make space and time to get in this dimension.

This liberation of time is also fundamental to understand the experience of care.

To be in a role

The spirit of care is not the one of the ordinary life, of the world of work, of networks, of communication, where everyone has a role. Heidegger names this situation “**to be in a role**”.

We are **DA-SEIN** because we are aware to be here, because we are with the others and we are also *dasein* because we present ourself in the world in a role. We all have a role.

For example, when we come back from the office and play with a child, telling him a story or taking him out for a walk, we leave the register and the efficiency and we enter in a world governed by other laws and other times. If there is no time to dedicate to care, there is no care.

When we listen to our grandparents, we realize that we are turning, we are reaching another. And there is also a silent world, a silent way to communicate that do not use words.

Gift

Care is one of the great names of **gift**. There is no care without gift. It's obvious that care has to be professional. It is also know how. It is also education and high skills.

One of the biggest misunderstandings of our time is to have associated the gift, the present (**for free**) with the concept of **gratis** (**not for fee**).

So in the gift there is **ambivalence**. It is one of the highest action in life but it can also be a subtle tool of manipulation.

Gift in English means present and in German means **poison**.

The donation, the philanthropy has always been associated with some form of public virtue and praised and publicly recognized and appreciated.

Today we can see that the influencers receive gifts from the industries. So there is this **gratuitness** that is mixing up with commercials. Gifts in this sense are those that we give to the king, then to the city, to the church.

Gift in the domestic world

The situation was very different when the gift took place within the **domestic world**. The gift of time, of resources, of energy, of life were no less than those that took place in the public sphere and their value was equal if not greater. But for many reasons, attributable to power, strength, the household work was not recognized as a gift, but it refers to duty and obligation.

The actors of the public gift were generally men. Those of the gift private obligation were mostly women. So in traditional culture, honors and glory belong to men.

So the first act of subjugation of women was the denial and the no recognition of their gifts, the motherhood, the care, the education of children and young people.

Moreover, the **freedom** that men experienced in the public sphere disappeared in the gift **obligation** of women in the **private sphere**.

It's a similar situation for **sacrifices** offered to gods, kings and pharaohs produce credits for the sacrificers. The sacrifices made in the world of public produce salaries and wages.

Gender disparity

If we don't take in account the meaning of **recognition** that was hidden within the employment relationship and within the paycheck, we cannot understand the scope of this change. The salary of those women workers, employers, teachers, nurses were not different from that of their husbands just because they were lower. That **paycheck** had a color of **reciprocity**, of **dignity**, of **recognition** that were not the colors that those women knew inside their homes.

We don't understand why a nurse, a teacher, a domestic worker are paid hundreds of times less than a manager. Preparing food, cleaning bathrooms, sweeping rooms are activities that were once historically entrusted to slaves, then to nurses, to nannies, to cooks.

Let's imagine all these professions declined in the **family**. So slave, servant, nurse and finally to mothers, sisters and daughters. And therefore we learn to look at care activities as something that had to do for slaves, for servants and poor women.

This distinction between men and women is good up to a certain point because there has always been an elite of women who in their care in their sacrifice resemble their husband more than their female servant.

Market of care

It was a great invention. Those with purchasing power buy services on the market and we can have an **amplification** of **inequalities**. This is because people with low income will also be poor in time as they will have to work to live.

Care work is therefore poorly paid because it's still associated with the idea of **sacrifice** and giving as obligations. Public economic recognition of care workers continues to be insufficient as our gratitude towards them. And we know that care is an essential dimension of every good human life.

Being competent in care is not really a value: if the person shows himself to be competent in care, his competence is not valued because the economy was built around the male register of the **homo oeconomicus** of rationality and efficiency.

Even today when women reaches the top of business and politics, this dimension is never really questioned. Indeed, we often conceive work, organization and society made by the male cannon, where care lives in **clandestinity**.

When care exist, it is not recognized and in this way it is systematically **despised**.

Care market laws

If the market has to manage all the demand for care, it will do it but according to its **laws**. The value and the virtues of the economy and business are also changing the way and times that care uses because **efficiency**, **speed**, stress, **merit** also enter homes. They get into families and destroy what very little has remained of time.

So maybe we are still in the **register** of **time is money** and not that time is a gift.

In fact, while economic value grows when we **reduce** the time that we spend on it, the value of care grows **together** with the time invested. The more time you invest, the more it is worth.

So, **efficiency** says that our system is based on **democracy**. That means that **fastness**, **speedness** are values.

When we enter in the realm of care, the more time it is unproductive, the more time is dedicated, the more it's worth, the more care is precious.

Feast

These three words together make “**festa**”: **holiday**, **celebration**, **festa**.

Holidays is not just vacation but comes from “**holy**” , which is a saint day. So the celebration of holiday needs a lot of care and work and the care needs celebrations and feast.

The **capitalistic religion** wants to abolish the holiday and it has declared a war on it by filling the market and the network with an explosion of offers of entertainment that have nothing to do with the experience of the feast celebration.

The attitude of capitalism is to **create while destroying**. It's called **creative destruction**.

Capitalism and feast

Our economic system grows by destroying the free feast and offering in their place entertainment for a fee.

A feast is not just entertainment, because **entertainment** is a **product**. It can be sold and it can be consumed alone while celebrating can only be **co-produced** and **co-consumed** together with others.

Feast and celebrations are complicated affairs for capitalism because they contradict the capitalism itself. This because feasts are not efficient. They are neither meritocratic nor they respond to incentives because **everybody** has fun, there aren't differences of sex, gender, condition, education.

Feast and religion

But feast is a primary fundamental need and nobody can live long without celebrating. It's the holiday that marks its time: Christmas, Easter, for example.

So **holiday** is also a close friend of work because those who work love the holidays. For those who cannot work Sunday is the worst day of the week because it's like Monday.

The importance of the feast in the biblical world is great.

DOMINICA contains **DOMINI** and it means to celebrate God.

Even God needs company to celebrate. You **cannot celebrate alone**. So if it's true that the holiday is the God's great gift to the world, it is also true that this is a gift of reciprocity that the creatures return to God.

The idea of a sacred day removed from the time and logic of the world that is only dedicated to contemplation rather than action is particularly hated by capitalism. We can understand this through the slogan: *I can do whatever I can do*.

The celebration comes to remind us that we are not the master of the world that we inhabit, but we are only **guests**. The earth cannot be an object of a jealous possession but must become a place of relationship between guests.

Fallow and the law of the seventh day

In Italian, **MAGGESE**. This expression comes from **May** and is the month in which the Romans left the land to rest.

It is also a rule of life: you can use the land for six days but not the seventh.

The stranger is not a stranger every day. On the seventh day, he's a friend like everyone else. The animal works for you for six days, but the seventh day is not for you. It's for him.

We can say that a good part of the responsibility for the **environmental degradation** of our time is precisely this: we have forgotten the law of the **seventh day**. Because if man is the master of every day, he consumes the world like a commodity.

So today it's mandatory to reinvent a non predatory relationship with the planet that must be rooted in the sphere of **gratuity**.

We can observe that the struggle between this capitalism and the celebration and the feast is very deep and radical.

Symbolic capitals

The **culture of work** of the past century was created not by fake industrial feast but by popular religious and also non-religious celebration, weddings, baptism, days of remembrance...

The symbols of the celebration without the popular poor and gratuitous truth that had generated them only produce hybrid and monstrous creatures.

So true celebration, true feast requires generosity and attempts to reproduce celebration within company to instrumentally create a sense of **belonging** and harmony among the colleagues.

Capitalism is destroying these **symbolic capitals** that are slowly emptied, dismembered and turned into commodities and sold on the market.

Utopia

Gratuity is a deep need and desire that is planted inside human beings and it hides the desire for justice. There is this need for a bond that is deeper than profit and business and that is capable of reanimating **utopia**.

TOPOS means place.

So, there is another letter, that can be:

- **o**, and it becomes **OU-TOPIA**, that means “**no place**”, so an idea difficult to reach;
- **e**, and it becomes **EU-TOPIA**, that means “**good place**”, the promised land (**TERRA PROMESSA**, in italian) that is not here yet but we can build little by little and be aware of the steps that we are taking.

Divertimento

We are headed toward death. So **divertimento** is to turn your head away from that. That is also **distraction**.

They don't have the fullness of the feast. They are small fragments of feast that do not fool our spirit. They don't **recreate** us.

Recreation means to create something again and it comes from the feast.

Tenth lesson

The Fusion of Systems and the Digital Condition

Our age is marked by a deep fusion of the economic, informational, and political systems. These three domains, once separate, have merged, particularly during the pandemic, into a single dominant structure. The network is not merely a tool but a condition of being: it transforms the way we live, relate, and perceive ourselves. This condition is not “online” and then “life”, it is **on-life**, a seamless hybrid experience.

This transformation is rooted in voluntary participation: people chose the network not only for utility or entertainment, but as an ontological space of presence. The web has become the default structure for connection, information, and self-expression.

Exposure, Performance, and the Collapse of Intimacy

In the absence of direct social presence during the pandemic, individuals began performing their lives online. Every aspect, grief, suffering, joy, became content. **The profile replaced the persona.** The boundaries between public and private dissolved. We curated our identities, choosing what to show and what to hide, following platform logics that reward engagement.

Removed from the gaze of others, we became both directors and actors of a self that exists to be seen, not lived. This generated a paradox: the more we exposed ourselves, the more we lost the possibility of authentic contact.

Emotional Distancing and the Commodification of Fragility

As digital interactions replaced physical ones, an emotional distance emerged. Empathy was replaced by indifference. Vulnerability became commodified. What was once intimate, pain, grief, fear, was now formatted for visibility. Platforms did not simply host content: they **manipulated emotions**, fostering a culture of exposure and consumption.

Being in the network requires us to turn even our fragilities into monetizable content. This is the logic of **digital techno-capitalism: everything must be converted into product, including the self.**

Algorithmic Identity and Stereotype Reinforcement

Algorithms are not neutral, they reward what aligns with predefined logics. Men are shown content about gaming, technology, and politics. Women see beauty, relationships, and fashion. The logic of visibility reinforces stereotypes and shapes behavior.

Content creators internalize these dynamics, modifying their output to retain attention. This leads to a feedback loop: **identity becomes a product shaped by algorithms**.

The TikTok Aesthetic and the Artificial Authenticity

TikTok introduces a new phase of digital presence. Unlike Instagram's polished imagery, TikTok emphasizes **rawness, desperation, and quick consumption**. This apparent "authenticity" is itself a calculated aesthetic, shaped by market demands.

The platform encourages engagement by promoting emotionally charged content, often prioritizing fear, sadness, or anxiety. Even the most private feelings are reduced to **fragments** that are replicable, standardized, and decontextualized.

The Brain Rot Phenomenon and Content Degradation

TikTok also accelerates the trend of "brain rot" content: meaningless, ultra-short videos that provoke a short burst of attention or amusement. These clips spread virally despite their lack of depth. Their only function is to **capture attention**, even for three seconds. The reduction of meaning corresponds to the reduction of time and cognitive investment.

Even the comment sections, which should be spaces for dialogue, are flooded with memes and repetitions, devoid of real exchange or innovation.

Sharenting

A deeply disturbing trend is the **commodification of children**. Parents create profiles for their children and produce content around them, sometimes exposing them in ways that align with algorithmic preferences (e.g., eating, bathing). The children become the "workers", but the profits go to the adults.

This practice introduces a new ethical dilemma: once this content is uploaded, it becomes permanent, this is the **problem of secondary contentization**. The child's identity is fixed by others before they even become self-aware.

In addition, **baby influencers influence other children**, fostering **early consumerism**. Children become both the subject and object of content, manipulated to generate engagement and profit.

Misery Shows and the Spectacularization of Suffering

Another emerging practice is the **capitalism of pity**: the use of people suffering from illness, disability, abuse, or poverty as content. Often filmed without consent, they are reduced to emotional bait. We witness the revival of **misery shows**, already present in traditional media, now amplified by social platforms.

Such content often ends with a gesture of charity - money, gifts, or support- but behind this apparent altruism lies a mechanism of **entertainment** and **visibility capital**.

Vibes, Authenticity, and the Production of Atmosphere

Children and family content are also used to generate **vibes**, a kind of emotional or aesthetic resonance. But this, too, is a form of **objectification**. The child becomes a tool to evoke a mood, not a person. This aestheticization serves to deepen emotional manipulation and to fulfill market demands masked as authenticity.

Geopolitics of Platforms: Western vs. Chinese TikTok

It is essential to recognize that **TikTok in China is fundamentally different**. There, content is more regulated, curated for educational or developmental purposes. In contrast, Western TikTok maximizes volume and viral spread, regardless of the ethical or cognitive quality of the content. The same platform serves entirely different civilizational logics.

Government Propaganda and Militarization of Cool

Governments and institutions also use these dynamics. Even military forces produce “cool” content, adding music, humor, or trends, to **recruit** and shape public perception. This aesthetic manipulation hides the real stakes of war and conflict, replacing ethical reflection with spectacle.

From Visibility to Identity: The Platform Self

Digital capitalism reaches its peak when the self becomes the product. Individuals become entrepreneurs of themselves, managing profiles as if managing brands. The job market, social capital, and recognition are all linked to **self-optimization for visibility**.

Unlike traditional forms of domination (e.g., the master-slave dialectic), this model involves **voluntary submission**. We enslave ourselves to platforms, **sacrificing authenticity for approval**.

The Ethical Challenge of the Digital Age

What emerges from this lesson is the urgency to understand how the digital condition is not only technical but **ontological** and **ethical**.

The web is not neutral:

- It reconfigures relationships, values, and meaning;
- in the name of attention, it undermines care;
- in the pursuit of visibility, it erodes empathy;
- in the logic of engagement, it replaces wonder with repetition.

Being on the web means facing a new existential task: to **resist commodification**, to **reclaim authenticity**, and to **think critically** in a world that reduces thought to a scroll.

Possible questions for the oral exam

- 1- Logos and nomos
- 2- Legality and justice
- 3- Dialog and monologue
- 4- Power and democracy
- 5- AI and human intelligence
- 6- Interpretation and objectivity
- 7- Human rights and role of law
- 8- We are at the same time master and slave
- 9- Unus Homo, Nullus homo
- 10- Impartiality of the machine and thirdness of the law
- 11- Neutrality of the tool
- 12- Demo-cratos , Dromo-cratos
- 13- Gratuity (gratuity for free vs gratuity for fee) and utility
- 14- Connection and communication
- 15- Market and law (capitalism)
- 16- Responsabilità and imputabilità
- 17- Idea of freedom
- 18- Civiltà dei dati e diritti (dataism)
- 19- Potere degli algoritmi e potere del diritto
- 20- Human times : technology decide our times
- 21- Intention and will
- 22- Robot judge
- 23- Comprendere e conoscere